Year 12 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y12/Y12_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Year 12 joins the pack at version 3.1, so that every year group carries one version number: there is no earlier Year 12 paper. The core paper has the Years 7 to 10 structure (listening Parts A and B, reading Parts A and B, writing, maths in three sections, science) at the level of a student finishing IGCSE and starting A Level. Two further parts are given from their own booklets: the **cognitive ability screen** (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12`, with its guide `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`) and the **optional sciences** (`Y12/Y12_Optional_Sciences_v3.1`, with `Y12/Y12_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`). Do not mix papers and instructions from different years or versions: the question numbers, marks and band guides differ.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y12_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

- **Listening** (16 marks): Part A is an everyday phone conversation (a school student and her cousin at university); **Part B** is a talk at the level of a lesson (turning seawater into drinking water).
- **Reading** (16 marks): Part A is a web page for a summer academy; Part B is an opinion article, "Lost, and Better for It" (questions 8 to 14), in the style of an IGCSE First Language English text.
- **Writing** (16 marks): a story, or an essay that must answer a counter-argument.
- **Maths** (30 marks): three sections that are scored separately: **Fluency** (10), **Word questions** (8) and **Applied problems** (12). A scientific calculator is allowed in Section C only.
- **Science** (10 marks): end-of-IGCSE level across biology, chemistry and physics, with one working-scientifically question.
- **Cognitive ability screen** and **optional sciences**: separate booklets, recorded on this year's grading sheet (Section 7).

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 12** (age 16 on 1 September), the first year of the school's **A Level** course. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 10 (高一)**: senior-high maths year 1 (sets, functions including exponential and logarithmic functions, trigonometric functions, vectors in two dimensions), physics (motion, forces, Newton's laws, energy), chemistry (the mole and amount of substance, redox, the periodic table) and biology (cells and molecules). They have usually **not** sat IGCSE. Some come from an international or bilingual school that teaches IGCSE: ask which syllabuses and which papers (Core or Extended) they have followed. A student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 11 (高二). Ask the student and the family which grade and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs between textbooks and regions. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

What it measures. The student's level of English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E) against the English that A Level study needs; their maths against the end of IGCSE Extended and the start of A Level Maths, reported as three sub-scores (fluency, word questions and applied problems); their core science against the end of IGCSE; the optional sciences against the subjects they want to take at A Level; and, through the cognitive ability screen, a profile for planning support (never for selection). Section 6 explains how to read the results together to judge **readiness for A Level study in English**.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
1	Welcome	2	Assessor		These instructions
2	Listening: Part A (questions 1 to 8) and Part B (questions 9 to 16), 16 marks	about 17 (the recording)	Assessor plays the recording, or reads both scripts (Section 3.1); a small group is fine	Student paper pages 2 to 5; pencil; the recording	Student paper; grading sheet
3	Reading paper: Parts A and B (16 marks)	15	Student works alone	Student paper pages 6 to 10	

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
4	Writing: one task from two (16 marks)	10	Student works alone	Student paper pages 11 to 12	
5	Break	5		Water	
6	Maths: Section A Fluency, Section B Word questions, Section C Applied problems (30 marks)	25	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 13 to 19; pencil, rubber, ruler; **no calculator in Sections A and B**; a **scientific calculator for Section C only** (from page 17); no protractor	A scientific calculator for each student
7	Core science: 7 questions (10 marks)	8	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 20 to 22; no calculator	
8	Break	5		Water	
9	Cognitive ability screen: non-verbal 12, quantitative 12, verbal 12, processing speed (90 seconds, out of 60); strictly timed	25	Assessor gives it from the guide; a small group is fine	The screen booklet (one per student); pencil; a stopwatch; no calculator	Screen booklet; its guide (once)
10	Optional sciences: Biology, Chemistry, Physics (15 marks each); only the sciences the student will take; a short break after two	15 each	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	The optional sciences paper; scientific calculator allowed	Optional sciences paper; its mark scheme (once)
11	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 9**	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Sentence Reading Card (laminated); a plain card to cover sentences	Reading front sheet; Interview sheet (Years 11 and 12)
	Total	**about 122** (core; allow 125)		A clock or timer	Final mark sheet

A long day. The core (tasks 1 to 9) takes about two hours (allow 125 minutes); with two optional sciences the day is about 2 hours 35 minutes, and with three about 2 hours 50 minutes. The booklet names are in the list below. If the student is taking two or three optional sciences, the optional sciences and the interview **may be given on a second visit**: say so to the family when the date is booked, and record on the grading sheet which parts were taken on which day. The parent conversation runs alongside.

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths, science, the optional sciences, the cognitive screen and readiness for A Level), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

For each candidate:

- the Year 12 student paper, version 3.1;
- the cognitive ability screen booklet (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12`);
- the optional sciences paper (`Y12/Y12_Optional_Sciences_v3.1`), if any science is taken;
- the grading sheet (`Y12/Y12_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 11 and 12 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y11_Y12`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the cognitive ability screen guide (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`);

- the optional sciences mark scheme (`Y12/Y12_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`);
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y11_Y12`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a clock or timer, a stopwatch for the cognitive screen, a plain card to cover the sentences, and a scientific calculator for each student (with a pencil, rubber and ruler for each candidate).

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) can run at the same time with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 10) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is always 1:1.

2. Before you start

Room. Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Keep a scientific calculator for each student on your desk until they reach maths Section C. Keep the cognitive screen booklet and the optional sciences paper out of sight until their turn. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them.

Say (welcome): "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. Please write all your answers in English. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. You can use a calculator only in the last section of the maths, and I will give it to you then. After this paper and a break, there are some shorter booklets. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Pace of speech. Year 12 students may still be learning English: speak steadily and clearly, with a short pause after each sentence, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way. Do not slow down for an older student who seems fluent: the pace is part of the measure.

Access rules (the same in every year group, with the calculator rule for Years 9 to 12)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	Maths and science (core and optional); the cognitive screen
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English.	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture. In the cognitive screen, only the instructions and the worked examples may be read aloud or repeated, in English.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Record the number of L questions on the grading sheet: it is evidence about English. No Chinese in the cognitive screen.
Answers	**All answers in English.** An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**All answers in English**: numbers, symbols, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0 (this includes the "Explain" and "Show" answers in maths Section C and in science).
Calculator	Not used.	Maths Sections A and B: **no calculator**. Maths Section C: a **scientific calculator**. Core science: no calculator. Optional sciences: a scientific calculator. Cognitive screen: no calculator.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics on the grading sheet.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet. The cognitive screen is strictly timed; if extra time is given there, record it, because the scores are then not comparable.

Stopping rules

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Listening:** if the student scores 2 or fewer out of 8 in Part A (questions 1 to 8), you may leave out Part B: check Part A quickly in the minute after it. Say: "Thank you. That is the end of the listening." Record "Part B not given" on the grading sheet; the band then comes from Part A alone (band A). In a group, play Part B to everyone as usual; a student with 2 or fewer in Part A may sit quietly.
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it on the Reading front sheet. Do not move them on to Part B.
- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed. Give the calculator when the student turns to Section C (page 17); in a group, give each student theirs when they reach that page. If a student goes back to Section A or B after that, take the calculator back while they work on it.
- **Cognitive screen and optional sciences:** follow their own guides. A student whose English band from the morning is A or B still takes the cognitive screen: it is the part least dependent on English, and it is where such a student can show their reasoning.
- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it on the grading sheet.

Keeping the student at ease. Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly.

3. English

3.1 Listening (16 marks: Part A 8, Part B 8)

There are two parts, and each is played or read twice. **Part A** is everyday listening: a phone conversation between a school student and her cousin, a university student. **Part B** is a short lesson-style talk with subject vocabulary, statistics, a correction and an implied opinion: the listening that A Level lessons need, at the level of a fluent speaker of 16 to 17.

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y12/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace: one reading of Part A takes about 2 minutes 24 seconds and of Part B about 3 minutes 27 seconds, with the pauses; use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

Part A. Say: "Turn to the Listening page. There are two parts. In Part A, you will hear a phone conversation between Li Na, a school student, and her cousin Chen Yu, who is at university. I will play it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 1 to 8." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Play or read the Part A script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Play or read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Part B. Say: "Now turn to Part B, on page 4. You will hear a talk by an engineer, Dr Wang Hao, about turning seawater into drinking water. I will play it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 9 to 16." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Play or read the Part B script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Play or read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Read both scripts twice at the steady pace in Section 2. In Part A, say each speaker's name before their line, a little more quietly, both times. In Part B, read as a teacher gives a short lesson, without slowing down for the numbers or the subject words. At each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not repeat lines or explain anything.

Timing. The recording takes about 17 minutes: Part A about 7 minutes 42 seconds and Part B about 9 minutes 41 seconds, with one minute to read each set of questions, the 10-second gaps between the two readings and one

minute to finish each part. **Allow about 17 minutes** for the listening.

Script, Part A: a phone call to a cousin at university

Li Na: Hi, Chen Yu! Thanks for calling back. How is university?

Chen Yu: Busy, but I love it. I'm in my second year of architecture now, in Nanjing.

Li Na: Architecture? I thought you were going to study medicine, like your mum.

Chen Yu: Everyone thought so! But I always liked drawing buildings more than reading about the human body. [pause]

Li Na: Where do you live? In a flat?

Chen Yu: No, in a student hall on the campus. In my first year, I shared a room with five other students. This year there are only four of us in the room, so it's much quieter. [pause]

Li Na: How do you get to your classes?

Chen Yu: I cycle. The bus is free for students, but it stops everywhere, so it takes twice as long. By bike, it's ten minutes. [pause]

Li Na: What time do your classes start?

Chen Yu: On Mondays, my first lecture is at eight o'clock. On the other days, it's nine. Your school starts at half past seven, doesn't it? So you'd find it easy. [pause]

Li Na: Do you have a job?

Chen Yu: Yes, I work in a café near the library on Wednesday afternoons. In the first month, I got twenty yuan an hour. Now I get twenty-five. [pause]

Chen Yu: Some weeks are hard, though. Before my last project was due, I drew for fourteen hours in one day.

Li Na: Fourteen hours! I don't think I could do that.

Chen Yu: You'd be surprised. When you're building something you care about, you forget the time. [pause]

Li Na: I have to choose my subjects for next year soon. Any advice?

Chen Yu: Yes. Three of my school friends chose physics because the rest of us did, and two of them changed courses after one term. Choose the subjects you actually want to get up at eight o'clock for. [pause]

Li Na: That's good advice. Thanks, Chen Yu.

Chen Yu: Any time. Come and visit, and I'll show you the model I'm building. [pause]

Part A answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear (for example "studen hall"). This applies to Part B too.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** (the building drawing: architecture)		A (medicine: what everyone expected her to study)
2	**in a student hall**		"in a flat" (Li Na's guess, which Chen Yu corrects)
3	**B** (the café)		
4	**4**	four	6 or 5 (the first year: "five other students"); 3 (the others, not counting Chen Yu)
5	**10** (minutes)	ten	20 (twice as long: the bus)
6	**25** (yuan)	twenty-five; ¥25	20 (the first month: the question says "now")

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
7	**She could not work (draw) for fourteen hours in one day**	It is too long; she would be too tired; she could not concentrate that long; she thinks it is too hard	"She cannot draw"; "she does not like architecture"; an answer about the café
8	**To warn her not to choose a subject because her friends choose it**	To show what happens when you follow your friends (two of them changed course); to persuade her to choose what she really wants	"Because they study physics"; "because they are her friends"; an answer that only repeats "two of them changed courses" with no reason

Script, Part B: a talk about turning seawater into drinking water

Good afternoon. My name is Dr Wang Hao, and I'm an engineer. I design plants that turn seawater into drinking water. [pause]

Only about two and a half per cent of the water on Earth is fresh, and most of that is frozen in ice caps and glaciers. Everything else is salty. A litre of seawater contains about thirty-five grams of salt: roughly six teaspoons. Drinking water should contain almost none. So the challenge is to remove nearly all the salt, cheaply, from an enormous amount of water. [pause]

There are two main ways. The oldest is distillation: you boil the seawater, the steam leaves the salt behind, and you cool the steam back into pure water. It works, but boiling water needs a great deal of energy. Most modern plants use a different method, called reverse osmosis. Osmosis is the natural movement of water through a very thin skin, or membrane, from the weaker solution to the stronger one. Reverse osmosis forces it the other way: seawater is pushed against the membrane at very high pressure, pure water passes through, and the salt stays behind. [pause]

Let me walk you through the plant my team studied last year. First, seawater is pumped in through a pipe that lies on the sea floor, some way out from the beach. Second, the water passes through sand filters, which remove sand, seaweed and tiny living things that would block the membranes. Third comes the reverse osmosis itself. Finally, before the water goes to the city, a small amount of minerals is added back, because completely pure water tastes flat, and a little chlorine protects it in the pipes. [pause]

That plant produces one hundred thousand cubic metres of drinking water a day. Actually, let me correct that: it was a hundred thousand when it opened. Since the second stage was added, it produces one hundred and fifty thousand, which is enough for about half a million people. [pause]

Now the costs. For every two litres of seawater that enter, roughly one litre of drinking water comes out. The other litre, now twice as salty, is called brine, and it is returned to the sea. Brine is denser than seawater, so it sinks and spreads along the sea floor. Most sea creatures live near the shore, in shallow water, so the brine has to be released slowly and far out. The second cost is electricity. The pumps use a great deal of it, and at that plant the water costs about twice as much as river water. [pause]

Some people now say that a coastal city with a desalination plant never needs to worry about water again. I notice that the same city loses nearly a fifth of its water through leaking pipes before it reaches a single tap. I would rather fix the pipes first. [pause]

The sea is not going to run out. But turning it into a drink has a price, paid in energy and in the health of the coast. Whether a city should pay it is a question for all of us, not only for engineers. Thank you. [pause]

Part B answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the word is recognisable and the meaning is clear. Every answer is said in the script, and the questions follow the order of the script.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Specific detail (a number)	**35** (grams)	thirty-five; about 35	2.5 (the percentage of fresh water); 6 (the teaspoons).
10	Note completion (a process)	**block**	clog; stop; blocked; recognisable spellings (blok)	"pass through"; "filter"; "remove" (the sand filters do the removing: the gap needs what the tiny living things would do to the membranes).
11	Note completion (a detail)	**minerals**	some minerals; a small amount of minerals; mineral; recognisable spellings (minerals, minrals)	"chlorine" (added to protect the water, not for taste); "salt"; "water".
12	Process or sequence	membranes **3**, pump in **1**, minerals and chlorine **4**, remove sand **2**		All four correct for the mark. Pumping and sand filters swapped, or membranes before the filters, is the usual error: the student heard the stages but not "First … Second … Third … Finally".
13	Specific detail (a number), after a correction	**150 000** (cubic metres)	150,000; one hundred and fifty thousand; 150 thousand	**100 000**: the figure he corrects ("Actually, let me correct that"). 500 000 (the people). An answer of 100 000 shows the student caught the first number but not the correction.
14	Inference joining two parts of the talk	**Brine is saltier and denser than seawater, so it sinks and spreads along the sea floor; most sea creatures live near the shore in shallow water, so brine released there could harm them.**	Any answer that links the brine (salty, dense, sinks) to the sea creatures near the shore: "it is very salty and animals live near the shore"; "so that it does not hurt the sea life in shallow water"; "it spreads along the bottom where the creatures are"	"Because it is waste"; "because it is dense" or "because it is salty" with no link to the sea creatures; "so that it mixes" with nothing more. The question joins the description of brine with the sentence about where sea creatures live.
15	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**B**: he thinks cities should stop wasting water through leaking pipes first		A is the opposite of his view (he says the sea will not run out, but that is not his point); C exaggerates (he describes a cost, not a reason to stop); D is the opposite of his last sentence. He never says the people are wrong: the student must hear the implication in "I would rather fix the pipes first."
16	Main idea or speaker's purpose	**B**: to explain how seawater is made drinkable and to weigh the benefits against the costs		A exaggerates (he does not say plants should close); C is not his purpose (he "studied" the plant and describes its costs); D is one detail, not the purpose. The structure (the problem, the method, the stages, the costs, the question for all of us) carries the purpose.

What is in the Part B script (for the English team): about 510 words in 36 sentences (about 14 words a sentence on average); about 20% of the word forms are outside the 2000 most common English words (`wordfreq` list, names left out). It explains a process (reverse osmosis and the four stages of the plant); compares distillation with reverse osmosis, seawater with brine, and desalinated water with river water; gives statistics; explains subject vocabulary in context (osmosis, membrane, reverse osmosis, pre-treatment, brine, desalination); corrects a number ("Actually, let me correct that"); implies opinions without stating them (the people who say a city never needs to worry; the leaking pipes; who should decide); and uses discourse markers (first, second, third, finally, in other words, now, so, but).

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A** New to English
Part A 3 to 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C** Developing competence
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

If the two parts disagree in an unexpected way (for example Part A 5 or 6 with Part B 5 or more), use the interview to decide: the student may have lost easy marks in Part A through nerves or carelessness.

What to look for

- **Part A** checks everyday listening: questions 1 to 3 the main points, 4 to 6 exact details with distractors (five other students, twice as long, twenty yuan), and 7 and 8 implied meaning and the speaker's purpose.
- **Part B** is the step up. Questions 9 to 13 need exact detail from fast, connected speech, with distractors (2.5%, chlorine, the order of the stages, 100 000); questions 14 to 16 need the student to join ideas, hear an attitude that is never stated and see the purpose of the whole talk. A student who gets 9 to 13 but not 14 to 16 follows the content of a lesson but not yet its argument, which is the skill A Level lessons and essays depend on.
- **Part A secure, Part B 0 to 2**: everyday English is fine, but lessons taught only by talk will be hard to follow at first. Plan visual support, key vocabulary in writing and frequent checks for understanding.
- Compare with listening in the interview. If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading page. There are two parts, A and B. Part B is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

General rules. Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "copy" or "in your own words". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: summer academy web page (accessible; picture support)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
1	20 to 31 July	1	20 July to 31 July; 20.7 to 31.7. Do not accept 6 to 17 July (Session 1).
2	¥4 500	1	4500; 4 500 yuan
3	Engineering Design; Debating and Public Speaking	2	1 mark for each correct tick, minus 1 for each wrong tick (minimum 0).
4	¥9 600	1	9600 (7 200 + 2 400). Do not accept 7 200 (the fee alone) or 10 100 (the deposit added again: the deposit is part of the fee, not extra; accept 9 600 only).
5	A letter from a teacher	1	a teacher's letter; a letter from your teacher. Do not accept "the online form" or "a deposit".
6	Marine Biology	1	
7	300 words on why he wants to attend, by 30 April	1	Both parts needed: what (300 words, or "why he wants to attend") and the date (30 April). Do not accept 15 May (the deposit date).

Part B: "Lost, and Better for It" (an opinion article in the style of an IGCSE First Language English text: a personal anecdote, a concession, a study, a counter-argument answered, figurative language and a point of view to be inferred; about 760 words)

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
8	Explanation in own words	She no longer knew which way to go; she could not remember how she had got there; she lost her confidence (courage).	1	At least two of the three ideas, in the student's own words ("she did not know the way, and she was scared" is enough). Copying "sense of direction", "memory of the route" or "nerve" without rewording scores 0: this is the own-words check.
9	Vocabulary in context	ridiculous	1	
10	Inference	She relies on her phone automatically; the habit is so strong that she looks at the phone before she thinks; she depends on it even when there are other ways to find the route.	1	Any answer about automatic dependence or habit. Do not accept "she likes her phone" or "she could not see the tower".
11	Inference with evidence	She is pleased, grateful or warm about it; it was a happy, valuable meeting. Evidence: "the best conversation I had all weekend", or the detail of what he did (walked her to the corner, the bakeries, wished her a good journey).	1	Both the feeling and a piece of evidence are needed for the mark. "She was embarrassed" scores 0.
12	Effect of a writer's language choice	The phone does everything it is asked, without complaint and without stopping, like a servant; but, as the sentence goes on to say, being served all the time makes us "incapable". It is effective because a servant sounds like a good thing, and the writer turns it into a warning (we become helpless or dependent).	1	Any answer that goes beyond "it helps us": the idea of doing everything for us so that we lose the ability ourselves, or the twist from helpful to harmful. "It means the phone is useful" alone scores 0.
13	Writer's viewpoint	B: they are useful, but we should sometimes find our own way	1	A ignores "I am not about to suggest that anyone delete them"; C and D are overstatements the writer does not make.
14	Summary in own words	Two of: (1) when the app guides us we notice and remember nothing about the place (the mental-map skill fades); (2) we never speak to anyone (we miss other people); (3) we miss discovering unexpected or "excellent wrong" places; (4) we become dependent or incapable.	2	1 mark for each distinct reason in the student's own words. Two versions of the same reason score 1. A reason copied word for word from the text scores 0 for that reason.

Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 3 to 5	**C** Developing competence
Part B 6 to 8	**D** Competent, or **E** Fluent (see below)

D or E. Part B is a text of the kind an IGCSE First Language English paper uses, so it is at or a little above the age level of a Year 12 entrant. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. Six out of 8 with copied answers in questions 8 and 14 is a secure D, not an E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Part B** is the hardest text on this paper and the closest to what A Level reading demands: an argument built from an anecdote, a concession ("I can hear the objection"), evidence and a modest proposal. A Part B score of 7 or 8 with answers in the student's own words shows a reader who can follow an argument in English and say what a writer is doing.

- **Strong readers** reword rather than copy (8 and 14), give evidence for an inference (11), and can say what a comparison does rather than only what it means (12). Copying whole lines that are in the right place but do not answer the question is the commonest sign of a band C or D reader.
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy or copied lines. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Part B may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the Reading front sheet.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out, on the Reading front sheet. A Level and IGCSE papers are long; a student who is accurate but very slow will need reading practice and, possibly, an access arrangement assessment if there is a specific need.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

The tasks. Task A (narrative): a story that ends with the words "and for the first time, I was glad I had stayed." Task B (argumentative): an essay for a student magazine on whether exam results are the only fair way to choose students for university, with an opinion, reasons and examples, and **at least one argument against the writer's view, answered**. The plan is not marked. Task B is the demand of an A Level entrant: an essay that recognises and answers the other side.

Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4 (what a fluent 16 year old would do)
Content and organisation	Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task.	Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the story is a sequence of events with little shape, or the essay lists reasons without explaining them and ignores the other side.	Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Story: a narrator with a reason to leave, a turning point, and an ending that earns the final sentence; some control of pace and detail. Essay: a clear position, reasons developed with examples, **a counter-argument stated fairly and answered**, a conclusion; written for magazine readers.
Vocabulary	Isolated words, or only words from the prompt.	Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("very important", "good", "many people"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because).	Wide and precise vocabulary chosen for effect (in the story: sensory and emotional detail; in the essay: the language of argument: claim, evidence, however, admittedly, nevertheless, on balance); a range of linking words; figurative language that works.
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb forms, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear.	A variety of sentence types used for effect, including complex sentences and some short sentences for impact; tenses controlled across the piece; errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Mostly impossible to read.	Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words.	Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; a range of punctuation (commas after openers and in lists, speech marks in the story, apostrophes, colons and semicolons) used correctly.

Band by best fit, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

Band	Writing at Year 12 entry
A	Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese.
B	A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear.
C	A short connected piece (often 70 to 130 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing; the essay gives an opinion with one or two reasons and no counter-argument.

Band	Writing at Year 12 entry
D	An organised piece (often 130 to 220 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary; the essay mentions the other side, even if it does not answer it well.
E	See below.

Band E writing at this age. A fluent 16 year old usually writes 200 to 300 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with controlled, varied sentences, precise vocabulary chosen for its effect on the reader, and accurate spelling and punctuation. The story creates a narrator and a turning point rather than listing events; the essay argues, uses examples, states the opposing view fairly and shows why it does not change the conclusion. This is roughly the level an A Level essay-based subject starts from.

What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Nowadays, with the development of society") or memorised essay phrases followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.
- **The counter-argument** (Task B) is the A Level skill. A student who states the other side fairly and answers it, even in imperfect English, is showing the thinking that essay subjects need; a student with fluent English who ignores the instruction is showing something else. Note it in the assessor's comment either way.
- For A Level, the gap between the writing band and the other bands matters most: essay subjects (history, economics, English, business, psychology) are assessed almost entirely through extended writing. If writing is two bands below reading, name it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y11_Y12`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y11_Y12`). The sentence reading rules are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`, the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, and the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. All are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 12 starts at **Level 9 (sentence 25)**, the top start level. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring in the guide. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating, which you record on the Reading front sheet. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block in the Interviewer guide, including **subject choices and why**, **university plans and countries**, **independent study and managing a heavy workload**, and what the student knows about A Level. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English. Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2, the same for every candidate.
- **Speaking band:** give it using the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, and record it on the Interview sheet. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths page. You have 25 minutes. There are three sections. In Sections A and B, you may not use a calculator. When you get to Section C, on page 17, I will give you a calculator. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can, and look at every page."

The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words and symbols mean ("in the form $a + b\sqrt{5}$", surd form, $f(x)$, $gf(x)$, $f^{-1}(x)$, dy/dx with the rule for differentiating x^n, column vectors and $|\mathbf{a}|$); the example at the start of Section B shows what "Write an equation, then solve it" means. They are there so that an English phrase or an unfamiliar notation does not hide maths the student can do. The derivative rule is given on purpose: a student who has never met differentiation can still apply a rule they have just read, and that is part of what the question measures.

Section	Questions	Marks	Calculator	What it measures
A Fluency	1 to 6	10	No	Algebra at the end of IGCSE Extended and the start of A Level Maths, with no context: surds, an exponential equation by indices, composite and inverse functions, differentiating a polynomial and the gradient of a curve, column vectors and magnitude, completing the square and solving in surd form. Demanding on purpose: these students usually find routine algebra easy.
B Word questions	7 to 10	8	No	Maths given only in sentences, with no diagram: the student must read, decide what to do and, usually, form an equation. An arithmetic sequence and its sum, inverse proportion to a square, a quadratic from two numbers, and a speed-time equation leading to a quadratic.
C Applied problems	11 to 16	12	Scientific	Multi-step problems in real contexts with a diagram, a graph or a table: the cosine rule, a transformation of a graph, a cumulative frequency graph, a probability tree with conditional probabilities, a Venn diagram with set notation, and exponential growth with a decision to explain.

Calculator. Section C only. Before question 11, check that the calculator shows D or DEG (degrees). Note how fluently the student uses one (cos, powers, fractions) in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet: A Level Maths assumes it.

Marking. M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark. A correct answer with no working gets full marks unless the scheme says otherwise: in questions 9 and 10 (which ask for an equation) a correct answer with no equation scores 1, and in question 16 a tick with no figures scores 0. Units are not needed unless stated. Working in numbers and symbols is fine; any words must be in English (a reason written in Chinese scores 0, but the figures beside it still count).

What a Year 12 entrant may not have been taught. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 10 (高一)**, so **algebra is a strength** and much of this paper is familiar: surds (Grade 8), quadratics by factorising, the formula and completing the square (Grade 9, 配方法), exponential equations by equating indices (高一, 指数函数), composite functions (高一, 复合函数), vectors in two dimensions (高一, 平面向量), the sine and cosine rules (高一, 正弦定理和余弦定理), translations of graphs (高一, 图象变换, mostly for trigonometric functions), set notation and Venn diagrams (高一, 集合), and classical probability (高一). Some content on this paper is taught later in the Chinese sequence, or not at all, so it **may not have been taught** even to a strong student: **differentiation** (导数, 高二), arithmetic sequences and their sum (数列, usually 高二, although many students meet the sum formula earlier), inverse functions written as $f^{-1}(x)$ (反函数 is touched on only briefly in 高一), **cumulative frequency graphs** and quartiles read from them (Chinese statistics uses frequency histograms and percentiles instead), conditional probability on a tree diagram (条件概率, 高二) and the English conventions of "show how you decide". A student from an IGCSE school should have met all of it. Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught: a strong 高一 student usually learns these quickly.

Section A: Fluency (no calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Surds: expanding brackets	$3 - \sqrt{5}$ ($a = 3$, $b = -1$)	B1. ($5 - 2\sqrt{5} + \sqrt{5} - 2$.) An answer of $3 - 3\sqrt{5}$ or $3 + \sqrt{5}$ shows a sign slip in the middle terms; $7 - \sqrt{5}$ means $\sqrt{5} \times \sqrt{5}$ was taken as 25 or 10: note which.	Secure (Grade 8, 二次根式).
2	Exponential equation by equating indices	$x = 5/2$ (2.5)	B1. ($81 = 3^4$, so $2x - 1 = 4$.) An answer of 2 (from $2x = 4$) or 41 (from $2x - 1 = 81$) scores 0; note the second: it means indices were not understood.	Secure (高一, 指数与指数函数; index laws are Grade 8).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
3	Composite and inverse functions	(a) 5 (b) $f^{-1}(x) = 2x + 3$	(a) B1: f(7) = 2, g(2) = 5. An answer of 23.5 is fg(7) (the functions in the wrong order). (b) B1. Accept $y = 2x + 3$ or equivalents. An answer of $2/(x - 3)$ scores 0: it confuses the inverse with the reciprocal.	Composite functions are 高一. The notation f^{-1} may not have been taught (反函数 is only touched on); the example box explains it, and a student who uses it correctly after reading it is showing the learning A Level needs.
4	Differentiating a polynomial; the gradient of a curve	(a) $3x^2 - 12x + 5$ (b) −7	(a) B1: all three terms correct. (b) B1 (follow through from their dy/dx if it has at least two correct terms). An answer of −6 for (b) (substituting $x = 2$ into y) scores 0 and shows that the gradient function was not understood.	**Differentiation is 高二 (导数): may not have been taught.** The example box gives the rule; a student who applies it correctly is reading mathematics in English and generalising a rule, which is exactly what A Level Maths asks for.
5	Column vectors: scalar multiple and magnitude	(a) (8, −6) as a column vector (b) $\sqrt{10}$	(a) B1. (6 + 2, −2 − 4.) An answer of (4, 2) is $2\mathbf{a} + \mathbf{b}$; (1, −5) is $\mathbf{a} - \mathbf{b}$. (b) B1 for $\sqrt{10}$ ($\mathbf{a} + \mathbf{b}$ = (1, 3), so $\sqrt{(1 + 9)}$). Accept 3.16 with $\sqrt{10}$ seen; 3.16 alone is B0 (surd form asked for). 4 (1 + 3) scores 0: the magnitude is not understood.	Secure for a 高一 student (平面向量, 必修二), who writes vectors as (3, −1) rather than in a column: accept either. A student from an IGCSE school knows column vectors.
6	Completing the square; solving in surd form	(a) $(x - 4)^2 - 13$ (b) $x = 4 + \sqrt{13}$ or $x = 4 - \sqrt{13}$	(a) B1. $(x - 4)^2 + 13$ or $(x - 4)^2 - 19$ (3 + 16) scores 0. (b) B1 for $4 \pm \sqrt{13}$, following through from a correct form; accept $(8 \pm \sqrt{52})/2$ from the formula. Decimals (7.61 and 0.39) alone score B0 (surd form asked for).	Secure (Grade 9, 配方法 and 公式法).

Section B: Word questions (no calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
7	Arithmetic sequence: nth term and sum	(a) Week 15 (b) ¥636	(a) B1: $6n + 14 > 100$, or listing to 104 in week 15. Week 14 (¥98, not yet more than 100) scores 0. (b) B1: 12/2 × (20 + 86) = 636, or 12 × 20 + 6 × 66, or adding the twelve terms. ¥86 (the twelfth week's amount, not the total) scores 0.	The sum of an arithmetic sequence (等差数列) is usually 高二: may not have been taught, but adding twelve numbers or pairing them (Gauss) is within reach of any strong student. The English of "first save more than" is the thing to check if (a) is wrong: read it aloud.
8	Inverse proportion to a square	40 units	M1 for $B = k/d^2$ with k = 360 (90 × 4), or $B \times 9 = 90 \times 4$; A1 for 40. 60 (inverse proportion to the distance, 90 × 2/3) scores 0: "the square" was missed. 202.5 (direct proportion to the square) scores 0.	Inverse proportion (反比例函数) is Grade 9; "inversely proportional to the square" is less familiar. If wrong, read it aloud.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
9	A quadratic from two numbers (sum and sum of squares)	2 and 7	B1 for a correct equation in one unknown: $x^2 + (9 - x)^2 = 53$, or $x^2 - 9x + 14 = 0$ (or the pair $x + y = 9$, $x^2 + y^2 = 53$ reduced to one unknown); B1 for 2 and 7. Correct answer with no equation (trial): 1 mark. The equation $(9 - x)^2$ expanded as $81 - x^2$ or $81 + x^2$ scores 0 for the equation.	Secure (Grade 9, 一元二次方程的应用). If it is wrong or blank but the student solves it once it is read aloud, the barrier is English.
10	A speed-time equation leading to a quadratic	12 km/h	M1 for a correct equation: $12/v - 12/(v + 3) = 1/5$ (12 minutes as 1/5 hour; or 0.2) or equivalent ($12/v - 12/(v + 3) = 12/60$); A1 for 12. The quadratic $v^2 + 3v - 180 = 0$ factorises as $(v + 15)(v - 12)$. Using 12 (minutes) instead of 1/5 hour on the right-hand side is M0 A0 (units not converted): note it. Correct answer with no equation: 1 mark.	Secure maths: a classic 分式方程 application from Grade 8. If it is wrong, the English is the likely barrier: read it aloud.

Section C: Applied problems (scientific calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
11	The cosine rule in context	125 m (125.0)	M1 for $AB^2 = 120^2 + 95^2 - 2 \times 120 \times 95 \times \cos 70°$ (= 15 627); A1 for 125 (accept 125.0 or 125.01). An answer of 153 (14 400 + 9 025 + 7 798: a plus sign) is M0. 149 or 160 means the sine rule or Pythagoras was used: M0. cos 70 = 0.634 means the calculator is in radians: note it.	Secure for a 高一 student (余弦定理, 必修二). The English "3 significant figures" is the thing to check.
12	Transformations of graphs	(a) (2, 8) (b) (1, 5)	(a) B1. (b) B1. An answer of (3, 5) for (b) is the common error: f(x + 1) moves the curve 1 to the **left**. (2, 6) for (b) treats the +1 as a vertical move.	Translations of graphs are 高一 (图象的平移, mostly for $y = \sin(x + \phi)$), so the idea is familiar but the f($x + a$) notation may be new. The left-right error is common everywhere.
13	Cumulative frequency graph: median and interquartile range	(a) 60 (b) 31	(a) B1: read at cumulative frequency 40; accept 59 to 61. (b) M1 for reading at 20 and 60 (lower quartile about 44, upper quartile about 75), or 75 – 44 seen; A1 for 29 to 33. Reading the quartiles at marks 25 and 75 on the horizontal axis (giving cumulative frequencies, about 4 and 60) scores 0: the axes were confused. 100 – 0 (the range) scores 0.	**Cumulative frequency graphs and quartiles are not taught in Chinese schools** (statistics uses frequency histograms, the median from a histogram and percentiles): may not have been taught. A student from an IGCSE school knows them.
14	Probability tree with conditional probabilities	(a) 0.3 and 0.6 (b) 0.34	(a) B1 for both missing probabilities. (b) B1 for 0.34 (0.6 × 0.3 + 0.4 × 0.4 = 0.18 + 0.16); accept 17/50. 0.18 or 0.16 alone (one route) scores 0 for (b); 0.46 or 0.48 (treating the matches as independent with 0.6 or 0.7 for the second) scores 0: the conditional probabilities were not used.	Tree diagrams are Grade 9 (树状图). Conditional probability as such is 高二 (条件概率), but the tree gives the probabilities, so a 高一 student can complete it: usually within reach.
15	Venn diagram and set notation	(a) P only 16, P ∩ C 8, C only 10, outside 6; n(P ∩ C) = 8 (b) 13/20	(a) B1 for 8 in the intersection with the other three regions correct (24 + 18 – 34 = 8). 24 and 18 written inside the circles with the overlap empty (and the total 48) scores 0. (b) B1 for 26/40 = 13/20 (accept 0.65, 65%), following through from a diagram with the right structure. 8/40 (both subjects) or 34/40 (at least one) scores 0.	Sets, Venn diagrams and the notation ∩ and ∪ are the first topic of 高一 (集合): secure. The English "exactly one" is the thing to check.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
16	Exponential growth with a decision (Show)	No: after 8 years the population is about 58 500, below 60 000	M1 for $48\,000 \times 1.025^8$, or the table completed correctly to year 8 (50 430, 51 691, 52 983, 54 308, 55 665, 57 057, 58 483; rounded to the nearest whole number or ten is fine); A1 for "No" with 58 483 (accept 58 400 to 58 500) seen. A tick with no figures scores 0. Adding ¥1 200 a year (simple growth: 57 600 in year 8) also reaches "No" but is M0 A0: the growth was not compounded. 48 000 × 1.2 = 57 600 (adding the percentages) is M0. The population first passes 60 000 in year 10 (61 444).	Exponential growth is 高一 (指数函数的应用) and repeated percentage change is Grade 9 (增长率): usually secure. The decision and "show how you decide" are the unfamiliar part: a correct tick with no working is common and scores 0.

Sub-scores and total: Fluency (questions 1 to 6) / 10; Word questions (7 to 10) / 8; Applied (11 to 16) / 12; total / 30.

Band guide (provisional, for a demanding paper; review after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 10 (under 35%): **1** Below expected; 11 to 16 (35 to 54%): **2** Working towards; 17 to 22 (55 to 74%): **3** Expected; 23 to 30 (75% or more): **4** Greater depth, likely top set and a candidate for Further Maths.

Not tested in version 3.1 (not enough time): inequalities, circle theorems, similarity with area and volume factors, upper and lower bounds, the sine rule, histograms, simultaneous equations with one quadratic. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for setting, and use the optional sciences for applied calculation.

Reading the three sub-scores

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency high (7 or more out of 10), **word questions low** (3 or less out of 8)	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Read the word questions aloud in English and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark L). If the student then solves them, record "English barrier in maths" on the grading sheet. This student needs maths vocabulary and practice in reading problems, not a lower course.
Fluency and word questions high, **applied low** (5 or less out of 12)	The student calculates and sets up equations well but is less practised in multi-step problems in context, in reading graphs and in explaining a decision. Check the NT topics first: questions 13 and 14 include content a 高一 student has not met.	Teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Practice with "explain" and "show that" questions.
All three high (band 4)	A strong mathematician who can read and apply.	A Level Maths; discuss Further Maths if the school offers it.
Fluency low, word questions and applied higher	Unusual for a student from a Chinese mainstream school; more common from an international school where formal algebra comes later.	Check which algebra has been taught. A Level Maths may still fit, with an algebra catch-up plan and a review after one term.
All three low, not explained by NT or L	Gaps in earlier learning, or a possible learning need.	Look at the quantitative reasoning score on the cognitive screen, then consider further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).

What to look for

- **Strong responses** show organised working, correct notation and a decision backed by figures (question 16), and attempt the unfamiliar topics (questions 4, 13 and 14) by reading the example box or the diagram, even when they are new.
- **A correct tick with no reason** (question 16) is common from students used to answer-only questions. It scores 0, but it is a habit that can be taught quickly, not a gap in maths: note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **English or maths?** Question 10 is maths that almost every Chinese-school student knows well (a 分式方程 application). If it is wrong or blank but the student solves it once it is read aloud, the barrier is English. The same check works for questions 7 to 9.

- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (questions 1, 2, 5, 6, 9, 10, 11 and 15), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions (3b, 4, 7, 13 and 14), write the likely band once taught in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

What a Year 12 entrant may not have been taught. A student who has completed 高一 has done three years of junior-high biology and physics, one year of junior-high chemistry (Grade 9) and the first senior-high year of all three (physics: motion, forces, Newton's laws, energy; chemistry: the mole, redox, the periodic table, electrolytes; biology: cells and molecules). Everything on this core paper has usually been taught, with two exceptions noted below (question 5, the wave equation, is 高二 physics; the ecology terms in question 1 are Grade 8 biology and may be half-remembered). Judge scientific thinking from question 4, and judge the sciences the student will take from the optional papers.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Food chains: trophic levels	Frog	B1. "Grasshopper" (the primary consumer) or "snake" (the tertiary consumer) scores 0; note which, because both show the chain was understood but not the term.	Food chains are Grade 8 biology (生态系统); the term "secondary consumer" in English is the thing to check.
2	Series circuits: resistance and current	(a) 12 Ω (b) 0.5 A	(a) B1. 2.67 Ω (resistors treated as parallel) scores 0. (b) B1 for 0.5 (6 ÷ 12), following through from their total (6 ÷ 2.67 = 2.25 A scores B1 only if (a) was 2.67). 1.5 A (6 ÷ 4) or 0.75 A (6 ÷ 8) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 9 physics, 串联电路 and 欧姆定律).
3	The mole: moles from mass	0.25 mol	B1. (M_r = 24 + 16 = 40; 10.0 ÷ 40.) An answer of 0.42 (10 ÷ 24, the oxygen forgotten) or 400 (10 × 40) scores 0.	Secure (高一 chemistry, 物质的量).
4	Working scientifically: pattern, variables, evaluating a method	(a) Height increases with fertiliser up to 2 g per litre, then decreases (b) One control variable (c) One sensible improvement	(a) B1: both parts of the pattern needed (the rise and the fall); "more fertiliser, taller plant" alone scores 0 because it ignores 3 and 4 g per litre. (b) B1: the same type (species) of plant, the same size of plant at the start, the same amount (volume) of water, the same soil, the same pot, the same light, the same temperature, the same time (4 weeks). Do not accept "the fertiliser" or "the height". (c) B1: grow several plants at each concentration and find the mean height; repeat the experiment; measure the mass (dry mass) as well as height; use more concentrations between 1 and 3. Do not accept "do it more carefully".	Fertiliser and plant growth are Grade 7 biology. Evaluating a method is less familiar: score what the student writes.
5	The wave equation	20 m/s	B1. (50 × 0.4.) 125 (50 ÷ 0.4) or 0.008 scores 0.	$v = f\lambda$ is 高二 physics (机械波): may not have been taught, but the equation is given on the paper, so a student can read the wavelength (0.4 m) from the diagram and multiply.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
6	Ionic compounds: conduction when molten	Ions can move when molten (free to move, carry the charge); in the solid, the ions are held in fixed positions (in a lattice) and cannot move	B1 for the idea that the **ions** move when molten and not when solid. "Electrons move" scores 0 (this is the common confusion with metals). "Because it melts" scores 0.	Secure (高一 chemistry, 电解质 and 离子键; Grade 9 introduces ions).
7	Gas exchange: adaptations of the alveolus	One feature with its reason: a wall one cell thick (a short distance for diffusion); a capillary right next to it or a good blood supply (keeps the concentration gradient steep, carries gases away quickly); a large surface area from many alveoli (more diffusion at once); a moist surface (gases dissolve)	B1 for a feature **and** why it helps. A feature alone ("thin wall") scores 0 at this level; "it has air in it" scores 0.	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 呼吸系统; 高一 biology covers diffusion across membranes). The English of "feature" and "gas exchange" is the thing to check.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding. For the sciences the student will take at A Level, the optional papers (15 marks each) are the better evidence: see Section 6.

Not tested on the core paper (not enough time): genetics, homeostasis, enzymes, rates of reaction, electrolysis, organic chemistry, magnetism, radioactivity, momentum. The optional sciences cover them.

What to look for

- **Working scientifically** (question 4) is the best guide to A Level practical work: a student who sees the rise and the fall in the data, names a control variable and suggests a real improvement is ready for practical work in English.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud. Science vocabulary in English (secondary consumer, resistance, moles, variable, molten, feature) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **Strong responses** use units (Ω, A, mol, m/s), give both halves of an explanation (question 7) and give precise answers in question 4 (for example "grow five plants at each concentration and calculate the mean").

6. Readiness for A Level

This section is guidance for the school to confirm, against its own admissions policy, the A Level subjects and syllabuses it offers, the entry requirements it sets for each subject, the university destinations its students aim for, and the support it can provide. It is not a set of fixed rules. Record the results on the grading sheet (Section 7) first, then read the results together.

English is the gateway. Every A Level subject is taught and examined in English, with long texts, extended written answers and essay questions. The demand is higher than at IGCSE, and there is less time: a two-year A Level course leaves little room for English to catch up. Look at the overall English band, and most closely at **reading and writing**, because the exams depend on them. Academic English usually develops more slowly than conversation: as a planning assumption, a student rarely moves up more than about one band a year in academic reading and writing, even with good support. A student at band C at the start of Year 12 is likely still to be at C or D when the exams come.

English band	What it usually means for A Level study in English	English course that may fit best
A New to English	Cannot yet follow subject lessons in English. Direct entry to A Level is not usually advisable (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).	A preparatory or foundation route, or a later start, if the school has one.
B Early acquisition	Can follow simple, supported lessons, but A Level texts and exam questions will be out of reach for most of the first year.	Direct entry to A Level is not usually advisable; a one-year pre-A Level or IGCSE year with intensive English, if the school has one.

English band	What it usually means for A Level study in English	English course that may fit best
C Developing competence	Can follow most lessons with support; subject vocabulary and extended writing will slow progress. Maths and the sciences are more accessible than essay-based subjects.	**English as a Second Language support** alongside A Levels in maths and the sciences only; essay-based subjects not advised in the first year, or a pre-A Level year.
D Competent	Usually ready for A Level courses taught in English, with support for academic writing; essay-based subjects possible with support.	English as a Second Language support at the higher level in the first year; First Language level if reading and writing are a strong D or E.
E Fluent	Ready for A Level study in English, including essay-based subjects.	**First Language level** (no ESL course needed); English Literature or Language at A Level if the student wants it.

What English band does a student realistically need? As a working guide for the school to test and review: **band D or above in reading and writing** for essay-based subjects (for example economics, business, history, psychology, English), and **band C or above in reading and writing, with English as a Second Language support**, for maths and the sciences. Listening and speaking at C or above in either case. Review these thresholds once the first groups of students have taken their A Levels.

What the version 3.1 English results add. Use the hardest parts as the evidence for A Level:

- **Listening Part B** is the best guide to following lessons taught by talk. Part B 6 or more: the student can follow a lesson-style explanation with subject vocabulary and hear its argument. Part B 0 to 2 with Part A secure: everyday listening is fine, but lessons will need visual support and key vocabulary in writing at first.
- **Reading Part B** ("Lost, and Better for It") is a First Language-style opinion article and the hardest reading on this paper. Part B 7 or 8, answered in the student's own words, with writing at E or a strong D: reads like a fluent speaker and is ready for essay-based subjects. Part B 6 or more otherwise: a competent reader who will need support with the longest A Level texts.
- **Writing Task B** (the essay with a counter-argument) is the closest task on this paper to an A Level essay. A clear position, a fairly stated counter-argument and an answer to it, in organised paragraphs, is the mark of readiness for essay subjects even when the English has band D errors.

Maths: A Level Maths, and what support. Read the total band with the three sub-scores (Section 4), allowing for NT. A Level Maths assumes the whole of IGCSE Extended (or its equivalent) and fluent algebra.

Maths result	What it suggests (for the school to confirm)
Band 4 (23 or more)	**A Level Maths: suitable**, likely top set. Discuss **Further Maths** if the school offers it, especially if questions 4, 5 and 16 are right.
Band 3 (17 to 22)	**A Level Maths: suitable.** NT marks on differentiation, inverse functions, sequences and cumulative frequency are expected for a 高一 student and are usually caught up in the first term.
Fluency 7 or more, word questions 3 or less (any band)	**A Level Maths with support for the English of maths**: maths vocabulary, reading problems, writing short explanations in English. The gap is English, not maths: do not advise against A Level Maths for this reason alone.
Fluency and word questions secure, applied 5 or less	**A Level Maths with support** in problem solving, reading graphs and explaining ("show that", "explain"). Review after one term.
Band 2 (11 to 16), mostly NT and L	**A Level Maths is still possible**: judge the band once taught, and review after six weeks.
Band 2 with errors on taught topics (questions 1, 2, 5, 6, 9, 10, 11, 15)	**A Level Maths not advised** without a catch-up plan; a pre-A Level year, or A Level subjects that do not depend on maths, may be wiser. Review if the gaps close.
Band 1 not explained by NT or English	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9). A band 1 that NT or L does explain is treated as band 2 (the guide, Section 9).

The optional sciences and A Level sciences. Each optional paper (15 marks, band 1 to 4 from `Y12_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`) is the main evidence for that A Level science. As a working guide:

band 3 or 4 in a science suggests **suitable** for that A Level; band 2 suggests **with support** (a content catch-up plan for the NT topics named in the mark scheme, and a review after one term); band 1 not explained by NT suggests **not advised** for that science. Read each science with the maths result (physics and chemistry at A Level depend on algebra) and with the English band (every science has extended-answer questions). A science the student did not sit cannot be judged: tick "not taken" and do not infer it from the others.

The cognitive ability screen and support planning. The screen is **not used to select**. Use its profile (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`) to plan support: non-verbal and quantitative both 9 or more with verbal low usually means strong reasoning and an English gap (plan language support, and expect the paper results to rise as English does); processing speed well below the other parts suggests checking reading fluency and considering extra time; all three reasoning parts 4 or less suggests discussing further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9); a strong profile with weak paper results suggests looking for gaps in prior learning or motivation. Write the profile note on the grading sheet.

When a one-year pre-A Level or IGCSE route is wiser. Consider it, if the school offers one, when: English is band B, or band C with essay-based subjects wanted; the student has not sat IGCSE and the maths is band 2 on taught topics; the optional sciences for the subjects wanted are band 1 or 2 with many NT topics; or the interview shows that the student does not yet understand what A Level study in English involves. A year of IGCSE in English usually raises the English band, fills the content gaps and produces the IGCSE grades that universities and the school's own entry requirements may ask for. Tell the family early what the school's requirements are.

Reading the results together (examples of common profiles)

Profile	What it suggests	A possible plan (for the school to confirm)
English D or E; maths 3 or 4; optional sciences 3 or 4 in the subjects wanted	Ready for a full A Level programme.	Full subject load; English course by the table above; A Level Maths.
English E, with listening Part B high, reading Part B 7 or 8 in own words, and writing E or a strong D with a counter-argument	Reads and writes like a fluent speaker.	First Language level; essay-based subjects open; no ESL course needed.
English C; maths fluency high, word questions well below it; sciences 3 or 4	Strong maths and science; English is the barrier.	A Level Maths and the sciences with ESL support; no essay-based subject in the first year; review English after one term.
English C or D; maths fluency and word questions high, applied low; cognitive screen quantitative high	Strong calculation and algebra; less practised in problem solving and explaining.	A Level Maths with explicit teaching of problem solving and "explain" questions; review after one term.
English C; maths 2 with NT on differentiation, sequences and cumulative frequency; sciences 2 with NT topics	Likely to manage with support, or better placed in a pre-A Level year.	If entry: ESL support, catch-up plans for the NT topics, maths and sciences reviewed after six weeks. Otherwise a pre-A Level or IGCSE year.
English B, any maths and sciences	The English gap is too wide for A Level content in two years.	A pre-A Level or IGCSE year with intensive English, if the school has one; otherwise discuss a later start (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).
English D or E; maths band 1 on taught topics; cognitive screen quantitative low	Not an English issue.	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9). If an offer follows, no A Level Maths, and maths support where other subjects need it.
Cognitive screen strong (non-verbal and quantitative 9 or more), verbal and all paper results low	Strong reasoning; the English is the whole gap.	A pre-A Level year with intensive English is likely to pay off; review the paper results after the year.
Strong results, but the interview shows the A Level plan (subjects, country, university) is the family's, not the student's	Readiness is not only academic.	Talk with the family and student about subject choices and workload before an offer (Interview sheet, suitability strands). A serious mismatch, or any strand rated 1, goes to the head of section before any offer.

Use the Year 11 and 12 interview questions (subject choices and why, university plans, independent study, managing a heavy workload, what the student knows about A Level) to judge whether the student's plans are realistic and their own. Record the readiness judgement on the grading sheet (the readiness for A Level boxes and the assessor's comment) and on the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

7. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y12_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too whether Part B of the listening was given, the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen (A or B) and whether the essay answered a counter-argument, any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Mark the optional sciences** with `Y12_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1` and record each science taken on the grading sheet (score / 15, band, NT, L); tick "not taken" for each science the student did not sit.
4. **Score the cognitive ability screen** with `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide` and record the four raw scores (Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60) and a one-line profile note on the grading sheet. It is not banded and it is not used to select.
5. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
6. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
7. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days (or within two working days of the second visit, if there is one). Write "v3.1" beside the scores on it: the listening is out of 16, the reading paper is out of 16, the maths has three sub-scores, each optional science is out of 15 and the cognitive screen is four raw scores. The overall English band is the band most skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands lower.
8. **File the marked papers with them** (or shred them under the school's policy).

Year 12 only: readiness for A Level. Read the results together with Section 6, then tick on the grading sheet the English course (English as a Second Language support, First Language level or to decide), A Level Maths (suitable, with support, not advised or to decide), the sciences (suitable for the A Level sciences taken, with support, or not advised), the readiness (Ready, Ready with support, Pre-A Level year advised or Not yet) and the support (English of maths, academic writing, content gaps, extra time to check, or none), and give your reasons in the assessor's comment.

Interviewer guide: Years 11 and 12

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y11_Y12`).

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme at post-16 (Year 11 joins the second year of IGCSE; Year 12 joins the first year of A Level). It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 5 minutes; start Level 9 for both Year 11 and Year 12; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak at a steady, clear pace, with a short pause after each sentence. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?
School and learning	Tell me about your school now. Which subject do you find hardest, and what do you do when work is difficult?	Do you like your school? Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard. What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?
Subject choices	Which IGCSE or A Level subjects would you like to take, and why? Who chose them: you, your parents, or both together?	Which subjects do you like best? Was it your idea?	How do they connect to what you want to study later?
	What do you know about the courses: the topics, the exams, any coursework?	Do you know what an IGCSE or an A Level is?	How is this course different from what you study now?
	What will you do if a subject is harder than you expected?	Would you ask a teacher for help?	How would you decide whether to keep going or to change subject?
Study and workload	How do you revise for a test? Tell me what you actually do.	Do you make notes? Do you practise questions?	Which methods work best for you, and how do you know?
	How many hours a week do you study outside lessons? Do you have tutoring?	Do you study at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?
	How do you manage deadlines when several subjects set work at the same time?	Do you use a planner or a list?	Tell me about a time you had too much to do. What did you do?
English for study	How do you feel about reading long texts in English, such as a textbook chapter or a novel?	Do you read in English? What do you read?	What do you do when a text has many words you do not know?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
	Have you written an essay in English? Tell me about it.	Can you write a paragraph in English?	What is hardest about writing in English: the ideas, the organisation or the language?
	How do you feel about speaking in class, asking questions and giving your opinion in English?	Will you put your hand up in a lesson?	What would help you to speak more in lessons?
University plans	What would you like to do after school? Which countries or universities are you thinking about, and why?	Do you want to go to university? In China or another country?	Why does that place interest you? What might be difficult about studying there?
	What do you know about what those universities ask for: grades, subjects, English tests, interviews?	Do you know which grades you would need?	What have you found out yourself, and where did you look?
Interests and service	What do you enjoy outside school? Have you taken part in service, volunteering, competitions or a leadership role?	Do you like sport, music or art? Do you help at home or in your community?	What have you achieved that you are proud of, and what did you learn from it?
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school? How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	Do you have good friends? What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities, sleep and rest?
Boarding (only if the student will board)	Have you lived away from home before? How do you manage your own routines: sleep, getting up on time, washing clothes?	Have you stayed away from home for a week or more? Do you get yourself up in the morning?	What will be hardest about boarding, and how would you deal with feeling homesick?
Values	A friend asks you to send them your essay so they can hand it in as their own. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy work?	Why does honesty matter in learning?
Year 11 only	You would join the second year of a two-year IGCSE course. What does that mean for you, and how would you catch up?	Do you know that the other students started the course a year ago? Would you ask for extra lessons?	In which subjects do you expect the biggest gap, and how would you close it?
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school or the courses?	Do you have any questions?	

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, using the evidence from the whole interview, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** (how much of your English they understood) with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet from what you saw and heard: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits
Independent study and readiness for post-16 work	Can describe how they study on their own, realistic about the workload, has read about the courses

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)
- Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary
- Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, they note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 12. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	9	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25	25	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Use a short pause after each sentence, and a longer one with the younger students. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 12 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 12
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.

Year 12 Admission Assessment v3.1: Optional sciences, mark scheme

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y12/Y12_Optional_Sciences_v3.1` (the student paper: Biology, Chemistry and Physics, 15 marks and 15 minutes each). The core assessment (English, maths, core science, cognitive ability screen and interview) is in `Y12_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`; this document covers the optional science papers only.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their **grading sheet** (`Y12_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), which has a row for each optional science (mark / 15, band, NT, L, and a "not taken" tick).

1. What these papers are for

A Year 12 entrant joins the **first year of A Level**. The optional science papers show whether a student is ready to start an A Level course in **each science they intend to take**: they test the end of an IGCSE course (Cambridge or Edexcel style, no board named) and the ideas an A Level course assumes on day one. Each paper has 6 to 8 questions, from easy to hard, every one with a diagram, table or graph, and each includes at least one calculation, one data question, one two-mark "explain" question and one working-scientifically question. The hardest question in each paper is meant to stretch a strong IGCSE student: few candidates will score 15.

Who sits them. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 10 (高一)** and has not sat IGCSE. Their science is often strong in content and calculation, but some topics come later in the Chinese sequence (Section 2 of each science below), and the English of science (command words, subject vocabulary, "explain" answers) is usually the gap. A student from an international or bilingual school may have taken, or be about to take, IGCSE: the papers then confirm the level.

Not standardised. The band guide (Section 7) is provisional. Review it, with the readiness guidance in Section 8, after the first 20 to 30 candidates.

2. Which sciences to give

- Agree with the family **before the day** which sciences the student intends to take at A Level, and give **only those** papers (one, two or three). Tell the student at the start which ones they will do; the cover of the paper asks them to tick them.
- A student who is **undecided** between sciences may sit the ones under consideration, up to all three. A student who will take no science sits none.
- **Order on the day:** the optional sciences come after the cognitive ability screen, each 15 minutes, with a short break after two, then the interview. If the day is too long, or the student is tired, the optional sciences (and the interview) **may be given on a second visit**: record this on the grading sheet.
- Give the sciences in any order; Biology, Chemistry, Physics as printed is the simplest. A student doing one science turns straight to that section.

3. How to give them

Paper	Time and marks	Materials	Print
Biology	15 minutes, 15 marks, 7 questions	Pencil, rubber, ruler, scientific calculator	One student paper per candidate (all three sections are in it). This mark scheme once.
Chemistry	15 minutes, 15 marks, 8 questions. Relative atomic masses are printed at the start of the section.	As above	
Physics	15 minutes, 15 marks, 7 questions. The equations are printed in a box at the start of the section.	As above	

Calculator. A **scientific calculator is allowed throughout these papers** (the paper says so at the start of each section). Give it to the student before they start. The calculations test whether the student can choose and use the right method, not arithmetic.

Access rules (the same as the rest of the pack, Section 2 of the assessor instructions):

	Optional sciences
Reading aloud	You may read **any question aloud in English**, as often as the student asks, and point to the diagram. Do not explain scientific words or hint at the method.
Chinese	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Record the number of L questions for each science on the grading sheet: it is evidence about English, not science.
Answers	**All answers in English**: numbers, symbols, units, words, working and diagrams all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0 (this includes the "Explain" answers).
Not yet taught (NT)	If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List the NT topics on the grading sheet; the "may not have been taught" column below says what to expect.
Extra time, a reader	Allowed for a known need: record it on the grading sheet.

Say (at the start of the first science): "You are going to do [Biology / Chemistry / Physics]. Each science has 15 minutes and 15 marks. The questions start easy and get harder. You may use your calculator. I can read any question to you in English, as often as you like, but I cannot explain the science. If you have not learnt a topic, tell me and go on to the next question. Write all your answers in English, and show your working. When you finish a science, stop at the banner and wait for me. Please turn to [Biology]. You may start."

Say (for the next science): "Thank you. Now turn to [Chemistry]. You have 15 minutes. You may start."

Timing and stopping. Keep each science to 15 minutes; give a two-minute warning. Encourage the student to look at every question, because later questions on a different topic may be easier for them. The student may stop a science when they have done what they can: say "That is fine. Thank you." If the student is upset or very tired, stop, take a break, and record it.

Marking. Use the tables below. **B1** is an independent mark for a correct answer or statement; **M1** is a method mark; **A1** is an accuracy mark that depends on the method. Where an answer is carried from an earlier part, **ecf** (error carried forward) is allowed as stated. Correct answers without working score full marks unless the table says otherwise. Units: accept the unit printed after the answer box; do not take marks off for a missing unit where one is printed. Spelling: accept any spelling of a scientific word that is clearly recognisable (for example "denaturd", "insuline"); accept the correct chemical symbol or formula in place of a name.

4. Biology (15 minutes, 15 marks)

What a Year 12 entrant may not have been taught. Chinese senior high biology begins in 高一 with cells and molecules (必修1: cell structure, enzymes, respiration, photosynthesis, osmosis), then genetics and evolution (必修2) in the second term of 高一 or in 高二. Homeostasis and the nervous and hormonal systems (选择性必修1) and ecology (选择性必修2) are **高二**. Junior high biology (初一 and 初二) covers cells, the human body, basic inheritance (dominant and recessive) and natural selection in outline, so questions 5 and 7 are usually familiar in content. Expect NT most often on question 6 (sampling with quadrats) and sometimes on question 4 (homeostasis).

Q	**Topic**	**Answer**	**Marks and partial credit**	**May not have been taught?**
1	Cell structure	C (chloroplast)	B1	Secure (初一 and 高一 必修1).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
2	Enzymes and temperature (data)	(a) 40 °C (b) denatured	(a) B1: accept 39 to 41. (b) B1: denatured; "the active site has changed shape" also scores. Do not accept "killed", "destroyed", "broken", "dead" (enzymes are not alive).	Enzymes and temperature are 高一 必修1: usually taught. The English word "denatured" may be the gap: a student who writes "the enzyme's structure (shape) is changed" has the idea and scores.
3	Osmosis: data and explain	(a) 0.4 mol/dm^3 (b) Water left the potato cells by osmosis, because the solution outside was more concentrated (had a lower water potential) than the cell contents	(a) B1 (the solution in which the mass did not change). (b) B1 for water moving **out of** the cells by **osmosis**; B1 for the direction explained: from the dilute cell contents (higher water potential) to the more concentrated solution (lower water potential), or "down a water potential gradient", or across the partially permeable membrane. "Sugar moved into the potato" scores 0 for (b).	Osmosis and plant cells in solutions are 高一 必修1: usually taught. Students may use the word "water potential" or "concentration gradient": both are fine.
4	Homeostasis: blood glucose	insulin	B1. Accept recognisable spellings. "Glucagon" scores 0 (it raises blood glucose). "Adrenaline" scores 0.	Hormonal control of blood glucose is 高二 (选择性必修1); insulin is named in 初二 biology (the endocrine system). May not have been taught in full: NT is possible but the name is often known.
5	Monohybrid inheritance (Punnett square)	(a) Pp, Pp, pp (with the printed PP) (b) 25% (c) 3 : 1	(a) B1 for all three cells correct (Pp top right, Pp bottom left, pp bottom right; pP is acceptable). (b) B1: 25%; accept 1/4 or "1 in 4" written in the box. ecf from (a) is not given here: the expected answer is 25% whatever the square shows. (c) B1: 3 : 1 (purple : white). "1 : 3" scores 0; "3 : 1 : 0" scores 0.	Dominant and recessive alleles and this kind of cross are 初二 (人教版八年级下) and 必修2 (end of 高一 or 高二): usually taught. The Punnett square format itself may be new; the question shows one cell filled in.
6	Sampling with quadrats: calculation and working scientifically	(a) 6 400 (b) To avoid bias (so that the sample represents the whole field)	(a) M1 for a correct first step: mean = 40 ÷ 10 = 4 dandelions per quadrat, **or** 4 × 4 = 16 per m^2, **or** number of quadrats in the field = 400 ÷ 0.25 = 1 600; A1 for 6 400. Full marks for 6 400 with no working. Common wrong answers: 1 600 (forgot the mean, or multiplied by 1 instead of 4), 160 (forgot to convert 0.25 m^2 to 1 m^2), 40 × 400 = 16 000: M1 only if the first step is shown correctly. (b) B1: to avoid bias; so that she does not choose places with many (or few) dandelions; so that the sample is representative of the whole field; so the estimate is fair or valid. "To make it accurate" alone scores 0; "to make it a fair test" scores 0 (this is not a fair test).	Quadrat sampling is 高二 (选择性必修2, population density by 样方法). The calculation is accessible to any student who can find a mean and scale up by area: do not mark NT unless the student says so. The word "quadrat" may be unknown: the diagram and the printed area carry the meaning.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
7	Natural selection (explain, 2 marks)	Dark beetles are better camouflaged on dark soil, so fewer are eaten by birds; they survive and reproduce, passing the allele (gene) for dark colour to their offspring, so the proportion of dark beetles rises each generation	B1 for the **selection** idea: dark beetles are camouflaged (harder for birds to see), so more of them survive **or** more light beetles are eaten. B1 for the **inheritance** idea: the surviving dark beetles reproduce and pass on the allele (gene) for dark colour, so more of the next generation are dark. Do not accept "the beetles changed colour to match the soil" or "the beetles needed to be dark" (Lamarckian or purposive explanations): 0 for that statement, but the other mark can still be earned. A bare description of the chart ("more beetles became dark") scores 0.	Natural selection is 初二 (生物的进化) and the end of 必修2: usually taught in content. Writing a two-step explanation in English is the challenge: an answer that gives both ideas in simple English scores 2.

Band guide (provisional, Section 7): 0 to 4: **1**; 5 to 7: **2**; 8 to 11: **3**; 12 to 15: **4**. Look at the NT and L questions before deciding (Section 7).

Not tested (not enough time): respiration, transport in plants and humans, gas exchange, the nervous system, reproduction, DNA structure, food chains and energy flow. Ask about these in the interview if they matter for the student's subject choices.

What to look for

- **Explaining in English** (questions 3b and 7) is the best guide to readiness for A Level biology, which asks for long written answers using precise terms (osmosis, water potential, allele, selection). A student who gives the right ideas in plain English is ready for the content and needs the vocabulary; a student who describes the data instead of explaining it needs teaching in how to answer "explain" questions.
- **Working scientifically** (question 6): a student who scales up correctly and can say why the sample is random has the skills for A Level practical work. Watch for the estimate given without working: ask them in the interview how they did it.
- **An English barrier** looks like blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud, or answers in the wrong form (a description where an explanation was asked). The words most likely to be unknown: denatured, optimum, genotype, offspring, quadrat, random, population.

5. Chemistry (15 minutes, 15 marks)

What a Year 12 entrant may not have been taught. Chinese 高一 chemistry (必修1 and 必修2) covers atomic structure, the periodic table, ionic and covalent bonding, **the mole and amount of substance**, redox and ionic equations, a first look at reaction rates and reaction energy, and a short introduction to organic compounds (methane, ethene, ethanol). Electrolysis (beyond the electrolysis of water in 初三), titration, equilibrium, collision theory and organic chemistry in depth are **高二** (选择性必修). So a Year 12 entrant usually has the moles calculation (question 4) but may mark NT on questions 3 (homologous series), 5 (electrolysis products), 6 (activation energy) and 8 (titration). The titration calculation itself is a moles calculation and is often within reach.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Atomic structure	12	B1 (23 – 11). An answer of 11 (protons or electrons) or 23 (mass number) scores 0.	Secure (初三 and 高一). Chinese periodic tables print the atomic number **above** the symbol and the relative atomic mass below: the diagram labels both numbers, so a wrong reading is a science error, not a format error.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
2	Bonding and structure: data and explain	(a) X (b) When molten the ions are free to move (and carry the charge); when solid the ions are held in fixed positions in the lattice	(a) B1. (b) B1: both halves needed in some form: ions **can move** when molten **and** cannot move (are fixed) when solid. "Electrons are free to move" scores 0 (it is ions that move in a molten ionic compound).	Ionic and covalent bonding and the conduction of molten or dissolved electrolytes are 高一 必修1: usually taught.
3	Organic chemistry: homologous series	alkenes	B1. Accept "alkene". "Alkanes" scores 0; "hydrocarbons" alone scores 0 (the question says it is a hydrocarbon); "unsaturated hydrocarbons" scores 0 (not a homologous series).	Ethene is introduced in 必修2 (end of 高一); homologous series (同系物) and the alkene family are usually **高二**: may not have been taught. The English term "homologous series" may be unknown even when the idea is: if the student asks what it means, do not explain; mark L only if a colleague translates.
4	Reacting masses (moles)	14.0 g	M1 for Mr of $CaCO_3$ = 100 **or** moles of $CaCO_3$ = 25.0 ÷ 100 = 0.250 mol; M1 for moles of CaO = 0.250 (1 : 1 ratio) **or** Mr of CaO = 56 used with the ratio; A1 for 14.0 g (accept 14). The ratio method 25.0 × 56 ÷ 100 = 14.0 scores all three. Full marks for 14.0 with no working. Common wrong answers: 11.0 g (mass of CO_2: M1 M1 A0, as the method is correct but the wrong product is found); 25.0 × 56 = 1 400 (M1 at most).	Moles and reacting masses are 高一 必修1: usually taught. The strongest guide to A Level chemistry readiness on this paper.
5	Electrolysis of a molten salt	lead	B1. Accept Pb. "Lead ions" scores 0; "bromine" scores 0 (that is the positive electrode); "hydrogen" scores 0 (there is no water: the salt is molten).	Electrolysis of molten salts is 高二 (选择性必修1): may not have been taught. A student who reasons from charges (positive lead ions go to the negative electrode) can still answer.
6	Energetics: reaction profile	A	B1.	Activation energy appears in 必修2 (高一) briefly and in 高二 in depth: may not have been taught.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
7	Rates of reaction: data and explain (2 marks)	(a) 100 s (b) At the higher temperature the particles have more (kinetic) energy and move faster, so they collide more often; more of the collisions have enough energy (the activation energy) to react, so more collisions are successful	(a) B1: 100 s (accept 95 to 105). (b) B1 for particles having more energy / moving faster **so** collisions are more frequent; B1 for a greater proportion of collisions having energy equal to or above the activation energy (more successful collisions). "The particles move faster" alone scores 1 only if linked to more collisions; "the particles collide more" alone scores 0 without the energy or speed idea. "More particles" or "higher concentration" scores 0 (the temperature changed, not the amount).	Factors affecting rate are 必修2 (高一); collision theory with activation energy is 高二: the first mark is usually within reach, the second may not have been taught. A student who gives only the first idea in good English is at IGCSE level; both ideas is A Level ready.
8	Titration: working scientifically and calculation	(a) 1 and 2 (b) 0.0800 mol/dm^3	(a) B1: titrations 1 and 2 (the two concordant results, within 0.10 cm^3 of each other; the rough titration and titration 3 are not used). (b) M1 for moles of HCl = 0.100 × 20.00 ÷ 1000 = 0.002 00 mol (or 2.00 × 10^{-3}); A1 for concentration = 0.002 00 ÷ 0.0250 = 0.0800 mol/dm^3 (accept 0.08). Full marks for 0.08 with no working. A student who uses a different mean titre (for example 20.25 from all four) can score M1 only, since the question gives 20.00. Common wrong answer: 0.125 (concentration × 25 ÷ 20, inverted): M0 A0 unless moles are correctly found first.	Titration is 高二 (选择性必修1): the idea of concordant titres may not have been taught, and (a) is often NT or wrong. The calculation is moles (高一): many students can do (b) from the equation and the printed data. Judge the two parts separately.

Band guide (provisional, Section 7): 0 to 4: **1**; 5 to 7: **2**; 8 to 11: **3**; 12 to 15: **4**. Look at the NT and L questions before deciding (Section 7).

Not tested (not enough time): the periodic table groups and trends, acids, bases and salts, equilibrium, metals and the reactivity series, tests for ions and gases, the chemistry of alcohols and polymers. Ask about these in the interview if they matter for subject choices.

What to look for

- **The moles calculations** (questions 4 and 8b) are the best single guide to readiness for A Level chemistry, which uses them from the first weeks. Clear working (moles, ratio, mass or concentration) with units is a strong response; a correct answer with no working is fine but tells you less.
- **The explain questions** (2b and 7b) show whether the student can argue in terms of particles in English. Watch for ions and electrons confused in 2b, and for "more particles" in 7b (a change of concentration, not temperature): these are science errors, not English ones.
- **An English barrier** looks like: the calculation done correctly but (a) parts blank, or correct ideas written as single words without the connecting "so" or "because". Words most likely to be unknown: neutron (usually known), molten, homologous series, decomposes, electrode, activation energy, concordant (not used on the paper), titration.

6. Physics (15 minutes, 15 marks)

What a Year 12 entrant may not have been taught. Chinese 高一 physics (必修1 and 必修2) covers motion and graphs, forces and Newton's laws, work, energy and power, and circular motion and gravitation; **momentum** is at the end of 高一 or the start of 高二, depending on the textbook edition (选择性必修1 in the 2019 人教版). Circuits and Ohm's law are 初三 (and again in 高二 必修3); electromagnetic induction and transformers are **高二** (选择性必修2); radioactivity and half-life are **高二 or 高三** (选择性必修3). So questions 1 to 4 are usually taught; expect NT most on question 5b (why a transformer needs a.c.), question 6 (half-life and background radiation) and sometimes question 7 (momentum).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Velocity-time graph: acceleration (data)	3 m/s²	B1 (12 ÷ 4). "12" (the velocity) or "24" (the distance) scores 0.	Secure (高一 必修1).
2	Resultant force and F = ma	(a) 30 N (b) 3 m/s²	(a) B1: 30 (to the right; direction not required). (b) B1: 3; ecf: their (a) ÷ 10, so 5 m/s² from a resultant of 50 N scores (b). An answer of 7 (70 ÷ 10) scores (a) 0 and (b) 1 by ecf only if 70 is written in (a).	Secure (高一 必修1, Newton's second law).
3	Gravitational potential energy and power	(a) 3 000 J (b) 300 W	(a) B1: 60 × 10 × 5 = 3 000. (b) B1: 3 000 ÷ 10 = 300; ecf their (a) ÷ 10. Using g = 9.8 gives 2 940 J and 294 W: accept both (the paper says g = 10 N/kg, but 9.8 is what Chinese schools use).	Secure (初二 and 高一 必修2).
4	Series circuit: resistance and current	(a) 6 Ω (b) 2 A	(a) B1. (b) B1: 12 ÷ 6 = 2; ecf 12 ÷ their (a) (so 3 A from 4 Ω scores). An answer of 2 A with (a) blank scores 1 for (b) only.	Usually secure (初三 Ohm's law and series circuits; 高二 in depth).
5	Transformer: calculation and explain (2 marks)	(a) 12 V (b) A voltage is induced in the secondary coil only when the magnetic field in the core is **changing**; a.c. in the primary gives a changing field, but d.c. gives a steady (constant) field, so no voltage is induced	(a) B1: 220 × 60 ÷ 1100 = 12. "4 033 V" (inverted ratio) scores 0. (b) B1 for d.c. producing a steady or constant (unchanging) magnetic field in the core; B1 for the principle: a voltage (current) is induced in the secondary only when the magnetic field (flux) through it changes. "There is no current in the secondary" alone scores 0 (restates the question). "d.c. does not have a frequency" alone scores 0.	Transformers and induction are 高二 (选择性必修2): may not have been taught; 初三 touches on generators. The calculation uses the printed equation and is often within reach even when NT. (b) is the hardest explain question on the paper: a correct answer is strong evidence of A Level readiness.
6	Radioactivity: half-life (data) and working scientifically	(a) 2 days (b) To measure the background count rate, which must be subtracted from the readings (so that the readings show the source alone)	(a) B1: 2 days (800 to 400, or any halving). (b) B1: background radiation (from rocks, cosmic rays, the air, the building) is always present; measuring it lets him subtract it from the readings (or correct them), so that the readings show the source alone. "To check the detector works" scores 0.	Radioactivity is 高二 or 高三 (选择性必修3): may not have been taught. The half-life reading can be made by any student who understands "half": do not mark NT unless the student says so; (b) is more often NT.
7	Momentum and conservation	(a) 6 kg m/s (b) 2 m/s	(a) B1: 2 × 3 = 6. (b) M1 for conservation of momentum: (2 + 1) × v = 6, or momentum after = 6 (ecf their (a)) with total mass 3 kg; A1 for 2 m/s. Full marks for 2 m/s with no working. Common wrong answers: 3 m/s (velocity unchanged: 0); 6 m/s (momentum given as a velocity: 0); 1.5 m/s (kinetic energy shared or 6 ÷ 4: M0 A0).	Momentum is the end of 高一 or 高二 depending on the edition: may not have been taught. A student who has met it usually finds this straightforward: the question is here because A Level physics assumes it early.

Band guide (provisional, Section 7): 0 to 4: **1**; 5 to 7: **2**; 8 to 11: **3**; 12 to 15: **4**. Look at the NT and L questions before deciding (Section 7).

Not tested (not enough time): density and pressure, moments, thermal physics, waves and the electromagnetic spectrum, parallel circuits and electrical power, the motor effect, types of radiation and their penetration. Ask about these in the interview if they matter for subject choices.

What to look for

- **Choosing the right equation** from the box, substituting with units and giving the answer with a sensible unit (questions 2, 3, 4, 7) is what A Level physics needs on day one. A student who cannot choose the equation when it is printed in front of them is not yet ready, even if their arithmetic is right.
- **The two-step problems** (questions 2b, 3b, 7b) separate a strong IGCSE student from a weak one: look for the first result used correctly in the second step, and give ecf as the table says.
- **An English barrier** looks like: the calculations right but the explain and working-scientifically parts (5b, 6b) blank, or correct physics in single words ("change", "field") without a sentence. Words most likely to be unknown: resultant, staircase, induced, background radiation, trolley, stick together.

7. Band guide and recording

Band guide for each science (provisional, the same for all three):

Marks out of 15	Band	What it usually means
0 to 4	**1**	Well below the level needed to start an A Level in this science.
5 to 7	**2**	Working towards: some IGCSE content secure, gaps in the rest or in explaining and working scientifically.
8 to 11	**3**	Ready for A Level in this science, usually with some topics to catch up.
12 to 15	**4**	Strong: ready, with the stretch questions answered.

Before you give the band, look at NT and L. An NT question scores 0 but tells you about the student's school sequence, not their ability: a Grade 10 student may reasonably mark NT on electrolysis, titration, transformers, radioactivity or quadrats. Judge whether the student would reach the next band once the NT topics are taught, and say so in the comment. A high number of L questions (two or more in one science) means the English of the paper, not the science, limited the result: say so, and look at the English bands together with the science. A band 1 that NT or L explains is treated as band 2 for the readiness judgement, as in the rest of the pack.

Recording. On the grading sheet (`Y12_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), for each optional science: the mark / 15, the band, the NT questions (by number and topic), the number of L questions, or a tick in "not taken". Note in the comment which questions were left blank at the end of the 15 minutes (time) and anything you observed (for example calculator use, working shown, confidence). If a science was given on a second visit, write the date.

8. How the result feeds the readiness judgement for A Level sciences

This section is guidance for the school to confirm against its own entry requirements for each A Level science and the support it can give. It is not a set of fixed rules. Read each science result with the English bands, the maths result and the core science mark (Section 6 of `Y12_Assessor_Instructions_v3.1`, which has the full readiness table for the year).

English is the gateway. A Level sciences are taught and examined in English, with long explain and evaluate answers, practical write-ups and technical vocabulary. As a working guide: **English band C or above (reading and writing) with ESL support** is the minimum to start an A Level science taught in English; **band D or above** to follow it with little extra support. A student with strong science bands and English at band B is not yet ready for A Level science in English, however good the science.

Maths matters for chemistry and physics. A Level physics and chemistry assume fluent algebra, rearranging equations, ratios, standard form and graphs. Read the physics and chemistry results with the maths result: maths band 3 or 4 supports them; maths band 1 or 2 does not, whatever the science band.

Science result (allowing for NT and L)	What it suggests for that A Level science (for the school to confirm)
Band 4	**Ready.** Likely to do well; consider it for the strongest subject choices.
Band 3	**Ready**, with the NT topics to catch up in the first term (list them on the grading sheet and pass them to the subject teacher).

Science result (allowing for NT and L)	What it suggests for that A Level science (for the school to confirm)
Band 2, mostly explained by NT (the topics that are 高二 in China)	**Probably ready with a learning plan**: the taught topics are secure. Set a short catch-up plan for the NT topics and review after six weeks.
Band 2 with errors on taught topics (for example biology 1 to 3, chemistry 1, 2 and 4, physics 1 to 4)	**Not yet ready for this science at A Level.** Discuss a one-year pre-A Level or IGCSE route, or a different subject choice, with the family.
Band 1 not explained by NT or English	**Not ready.** Do not offer this science at A Level; if the student insists, a one-year IGCSE or pre-A Level route is the realistic step.
Band 3 or 4 in science, English band C	Ready in science; **ESL support** and a limit on the number of essay-based subjects. Two sciences plus maths is often a better load than three sciences while English grows.
Band 3 or 4 in science, English band B	**Not yet ready for A Level sciences taught in English.** A one-year pre-A Level or IGCSE route with intensive English is the usual advice (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).
Physics or chemistry band 3 or 4, maths band 1 or 2	Check the maths NT first. If the maths is genuinely weak, A Level physics or chemistry will be hard: offer with maths support, or advise a different combination.
High marks on calculations, low marks on explain and working-scientifically questions in every science	Strong content, less practice in the written and practical sides of science in English. Ready, with teaching of "explain" answers and practical write-ups from the start.

Reading all three together. A student ready in all the sciences they chose, with English D or E and maths 3 or 4, is ready for a full A Level programme. A student ready in one science but not another should be advised on subject choices before an offer. Use the Year 12 interview questions (subject choices and why, university plans, what they know about A Level) to check that the choices are realistic and the student's own. Record the readiness judgement for each science on the grading sheet and on the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

Cognitive Ability Screen: guide for assessors

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12` (the student booklet, 14 pages). The screen is the same for Year 11 and Year 12 entrants. The grading sheet for the year applied for records the result.

What this screen is for, and what it is not. The screen gives the school a quick picture of how a student reasons with shapes, numbers and words, and how fast they work on a simple task. Its only purpose is to **plan learning support** once a student joins: which students may need help with English rather than with thinking, who may need extra time, where to look more closely. It is **never used to select**: no offer is made or refused on the strength of it, and it does not appear in the decision box of the final mark sheet. It is **not standardised**: the items were written by the school, there are no national norms, and the result is a set of **raw scores and the shape of the profile**, nothing more. It is **not a diagnosis** of any learning difficulty; that needs a specialist assessment. Until the school has its own reference, read every result cautiously. The school should **build its own reference once about 30 students have taken the screen** (Section 6.4).

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record the four raw scores and the profile note on the student's grading sheet.

1. At a glance

The screen comes after the second break, before the optional sciences. It can be taken in a small group with one invigilator. Timing is **strict**: every student gets exactly the same time, or the scores cannot be compared.

Part	What it measures	Time	Items and answers	What to watch
1	Non-verbal reasoning	**8 minutes**	12 items: pattern matrices, figure series, odd one out. Answer: a letter A to E.	No English needed beyond the instruction. The best guide to reasoning for a student with little English.
2	Quantitative reasoning	**8 minutes**	12 items: number series, number analogies, number matrices, simple relationships. Answer: a number, or a letter for item 6. No calculator.	Only simple arithmetic: it tests spotting the rule, not maths knowledge.
3	Verbal reasoning	**6 minutes**	12 items: word analogies, odd one out, simple deductions. Answer: a letter A to E.	English-dependent. Common words only, but a low score usually reflects English, not reasoning.
4	Processing speed	Practice untimed, then **90 seconds**	Symbol-digit coding: a key of 9 symbols, a practice row of 6, then 60 boxes. Score: correct boxes in 90 seconds, maximum 60.	Stop everyone at exactly 90 seconds. Check the practice row before the timed task.
	Total	**about 25 minutes** with instructions	Student booklet (14 pages); pencil and rubber; a timer that shows seconds	Record on the grading sheet: Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60, profile note.

You need: one student booklet per student, a pencil and rubber each, a stopwatch or a timer that shows seconds (a phone timer is fine), this guide, and the student's grading sheet. No calculators, no rulers needed, no dictionaries.

2. Before you start

Room. Quiet, bright, a clock the students can see, the booklet face down. The student writes their name on the cover. Students sitting the screen in a group should not be able to see each other's booklets.

Say (welcome): "This next part is a little different. It is a cognitive ability screen. It is not a test you can pass or fail, and it is not used to decide whether you get a place. It helps us plan how to support you when you join us. There are

four short parts, and each part is timed. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets them all right. If you are not sure, choose the answer you think is best and go on. I will tell you when to start and when to stop each part. You may not use a calculator. Please do not turn any page until I say so. Open the booklet and read the first page with me." Read the Welcome and How to answer sections aloud, then the table of parts.

Access rules for the screen

Rule	What it means
Instructions	You may read the instructions and the worked examples of any part aloud in English, and repeat them as often as a student asks. You may read any item in Parts 1, 2 and 4 aloud. In **Part 3** read only the instructions and the examples, not the items: the words are the task.
Chinese	**Not used** by staff for any part of the screen, even where a Chinese-speaking colleague is present: the screen is not scored in the decision and nothing is lost by a student not understanding a word in Part 3, whereas a translation would make the verbal score unreadable. Do not mark L on this screen.
Calculator	**No calculator** in any part. The arithmetic in Part 2 is small on purpose.
Time	**No extra time** within the screen, even for a student with a known need for extra time in the papers: the time limits are part of what the screen measures. Instead, **note any known need** (extra time, a reader, dyslexia, ADHD, a visual or hearing difficulty, or anything the family has told you) on the grading sheet beside the profile note, so that the profile is read in that light.
Answers	Letters and numbers only, so English is a barrier in Part 3 alone. A crossed-out answer with a new one beside it is marked on the new one. Two answers left standing score 0.
Stopping	A student may put their pencil down early in any part and sit quietly; do not let them turn the page. Never push a distressed student: stop, take a break, and record it.

Do not explain an item, give hints, say whether an answer is right, or tell a student to hurry (except in the Part 4 script, which asks everyone to work fast). Say "thank you" rather than "good" or "right".

3. Giving the screen: the script and the timing

Keep the timer where you can see it. Start the timer the moment you say "Start" and say "Stop" when it reaches the limit, in the middle of a sentence if need be. Collect no booklets between parts: the student simply waits at the stop banner.

Part 1, Non-verbal reasoning (8 minutes). Say: "Turn to Part 1, Non-verbal reasoning, on page 2. Look at the example with me." Read the example aloud and point to the rule across the rows. **Say:** "There are three kinds of question." Read the three lines. **Say:** "You have 8 minutes for 12 questions. Write the letter in the box. If you are not sure, choose the best answer and go on. Stop when you reach the banner. Start." Time 8 minutes. Give a one-minute warning: "One minute left." At 8 minutes **say:** "Stop. Pencils down. Please wait."

Part 2, Quantitative reasoning (8 minutes). Say: "Turn to Part 2, Quantitative reasoning, on page 7. No calculator. Look at the three examples with me." Read the three examples aloud. **Say:** "In most questions you write a number. In question 6 you write a letter. You have 8 minutes for 12 questions. Start." Time 8 minutes, with a one-minute warning. At 8 minutes **say:** "Stop. Pencils down. Please wait."

Part 3, Verbal reasoning (6 minutes). Say: "Turn to Part 3, Verbal reasoning, on page 10. This part is about words. Look at the three examples with me." Read the three examples aloud. **Say:** "Write the letter in the box. If you do not know a word, choose the best answer and go on. I cannot explain any words in this part. You have 6 minutes for 12 questions. Start." Time 6 minutes, with a one-minute warning. At 6 minutes **say:** "Stop. Pencils down. Please wait."

Part 4, Processing speed (practice, then 90 seconds). Say: "Turn to Part 4, Processing speed, on page 13. Look at the key. Every symbol has a number: the circle is 1, the triangle is 2, the square is 3, the plus is 4, the cross is 5, the diamond is 6, the line is 7, the V is 8 and the T is 9. Under each symbol you write its number. Look at the example: a circle, so 1; a plus, so 4. Now do the practice row. Take your time. Use the key." Wait until every student has filled the six boxes (about 30 seconds). Check each practice row against the answers in Section 4.4; if a box is wrong, point to the symbol and the key and let the student correct it. Make sure every student has understood before the timed task. **Say:** "Now the timed task. Turn to page 14. The key is at the top of the page. When I say start, write the number for

each symbol. Go from left to right along each row, then start the next row. Do not skip any boxes. Work as fast as you can, but try not to make mistakes. You have 90 seconds. When I say stop, put your pencil down at once. Ready? Start." Time **exactly 90 seconds**; no warning. **Say:** "Stop. Pencils down." Do not let anyone finish the box they are on. **Say:** "Thank you. That is the end of the screen."

Timing in a group. Everyone starts and stops each part together. A student who arrives late sits the screen on another occasion: do not start them part-way through.

4. Answers

4.1 Part 1: Non-verbal reasoning

Mark the letter only. Each item has one correct answer; the rule is given so that you can check a disputed answer and so that a future author can see what each item tests.

Item	Type	Answer	The rule
1	Series	**C**	The number of dots goes up by one each time (1, 2, 3, 4), so the next figure has 5 dots.
2	Matrix	**B**	Each row has one shape; across the row there are 1, 2 then 3 of it. Row 3 needs three triangles.
3	Odd one out	**D**	In four figures the black dot is inside the shape. In D it is outside.
4	Series	**B**	The arrow turns 45 degrees clockwise each step (up, up-right, right, down-right), so the next points down.
5	Matrix	**A**	Each row and each column holds a circle, a square and a triangle once, and white, grey and black once. Row 3 lacks a square and white: a white square.
6	Odd one out	**E**	The number of dots equals the number of sides (triangle 3, square 4, pentagon 5, hexagon 6). E is a pentagon with 4 dots.
7	Series	**C**	Two things change: the black quarter moves one place clockwise each step (so it returns to the top left), and the lines below go up by one (1, 2, 3, 4, so 5). Only C has both.
8	Matrix	**D**	The third cell in each row holds all the lines of the first two cells added together (row 1: vertical plus horizontal; row 2: the two diagonals). Row 3: vertical and one diagonal, plus horizontal and the other diagonal, gives all four lines.
9	Odd one out	**A**	B, C, D and E are the same flag figure turned by 0, 90, 180 and 270 degrees. A is its mirror image: with the ball at the bottom, the flag points left instead of right.
10	Series	**E**	The shaded sectors go up by one each step (1, 2, 3, 4, so 5) and the small black square alternates top-left, bottom-right, so it is top-left next. Only E has 5 sectors and the square top-left.
11	Matrix	**B**	The third cell shows the small squares that are black in exactly one of the first two cells, not in both (row 1: top-left and top-right, with top-right, leaves top-left; row 2: top-left and bottom-left, with bottom-left and bottom-right, leaves top-left and bottom-right). Row 3: bottom-left is black in both, so the answer is top-left, top-right and bottom-right. A simple "add them" rule fails row 1, and "take away" fails row 2.
12	Matrix	**D**	Three rules at once. The outer shape and the inner shape each appear once in every row and column (a Latin square), and the inner shading goes white, grey, black across each row. Row 3 lacks a square outside and a triangle inside, and the third column is black: a square with a black triangle.

4.2 Part 2: Quantitative reasoning

Accept the number written in any clear form (for example 20 or 20.0). Working in the margin is fine and is not marked.

Item	Type	Answer	The rule
1	Series	**20**	Add 4 each time.
2	Series	**30**	Take away 5 each time.
3	Analogy	**5**	The second number is half the first (6 to 3, 8 to 4).

Item	Type	Answer	The rule
4	Matrix	**9**	In each row the first two numbers add to make the third (3 + 4 = 7, 6 + 2 = 8, 5 + 4 = 9).
5	Series	**32**	Double each time.
6	Relationship	**E**	2/3 is about 0.67, larger than 0.6, 3/5 (also 0.6), 0.55 and 1/2.
7	Series	**17**	The gaps grow by one: +1, +2, +3, +4, so +5.
8	Analogy	**13**	Double the first number and take away 1 (4 to 7, 10 to 19); 2 × 7 is 14, take away 1 gives 13.
9	Matrix	**21**	In each row the first two numbers multiply to make the third (2 × 3 = 6, 4 × 5 = 20, 3 × 7 = 21).
10	Relationship	**4**	Two circles and a triangle make 14, and one circle and a triangle make 9, so a circle is 5 and the triangle is 4.
11	Series	**38**	Two steps repeat: add 1, then double (3, 4, 8, 9, 18, 19), so the next is 19 × 2 = 38.
12	Analogy	**50**	Square the first number and add 1 (3 to 10, 5 to 26); 7 × 7 + 1 = 50.

In items 3, 8 and 12 two pairs are given so that only one rule fits both.

4.3 Part 3: Verbal reasoning

Item	Type	Answer	The reason
1	Analogy	**B**	Hot and cold are opposites; the opposite of big is small.
2	Odd one out	**C**	Four are fruits; a chair is not.
3	Analogy	**A**	A bird flies; a fish swims (what the animal does, not where it lives).
4	Deduction	**C**	Li Na is older than Tom, who is older than Mei, so Mei is the youngest.
5	Odd one out	**D**	Four are feelings; tall is not.
6	Analogy	**E**	A shoe is worn on the foot; a hat is worn on the head.
7	Deduction	**A**	All of Class 4 play football and Wang Hao is in Class 4, so he plays football. The other sentences may be true but do not have to be.
8	Odd one out	**D**	Four are lengths of time; a clock is an object.
9	Analogy	**B**	Begin and end are a pair of opposites in a process; ask and answer are the same kind of pair.
10	Deduction	**B**	Sofia is on Amir's left and Jun on his right, so Amir is in the middle.
11	Analogy	**A**	Always and never are opposites; the opposite of everything is nothing.
12	Deduction	**E**	If rain always stops the game and the game did not stop, it did not rain. A (it rained) is the common error: it reverses the rule.

The vocabulary is kept within the most common two thousand or so English words. Even so, a student new to English may not know "afraid", "angry", "begin" or "middle": that is the English barrier the profile is designed to show, not a fault in the student's reasoning.

4.4 Part 4: Processing speed

Practice row (not scored): square 3, circle 1, diamond 6, T 9, triangle 2, line 7.

The sixty boxes, row by row from the left:

Row 1	**2**	**9**	**8**	**9**	**3**	**8**	**7**	**5**	**6**	**4**	**5**	**9**
Row 2	**8**	**6**	**4**	**1**	**2**	**8**	**5**	**7**	**4**	**7**	**4**	**9**
Row 3	**8**	**6**	**3**	**1**	**6**	**1**	**7**	**3**	**7**	**2**	**7**	**5**
Row 4	**6**	**3**	**5**	**4**	**9**	**2**	**1**	**3**	**6**	**5**	**2**	**7**
Row 5	**4**	**9**	**1**	**9**	**3**	**5**	**8**	**6**	**8**	**1**	**2**	**3**

Key: circle 1, triangle 2, square 3, plus 4, cross 5, diamond 6, line 7, V 8, T 9. The symbols appear six or seven times each, and no symbol is ever next to itself.

5. Scoring

- **Parts 1 to 3:** one mark for each correct letter or number; no marks taken away for wrong answers. Raw score out of 12 for each part. Do not combine the three into a total: the parts measure different things and a total hides the profile.
- **Part 4, Processing speed:** the number of boxes **correctly** filled in 90 seconds, maximum 60. A wrong digit, an unreadable digit or an empty box scores 0 for that box; nothing is taken away. Count every box the student filled, including any filled out of order. Write the score as a number out of 60. Also note the number of **errors** (wrong digits) in the profile note if there are more than two: many errors with a high count suggests rushing; few boxes with no errors suggests a slow, careful worker.
- Write the four raw scores on the grading sheet as **Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60**. Do not convert them to bands, percentages or ages: there are no norms behind them.
- If a part was not given, or was stopped early, or a student arrived late, write "not given" or "stopped at item 7" rather than a score.

Rough expectations while the school has no reference. From the design of the items, a Year 11 or 12 entrant who reads English at the level the programme needs will usually score **8 or more** on each of Parts 1 to 3, and fill **35 to 50** boxes in Part 4. A Chinese-educated student with limited English will often score as well or better on Parts 1 and 2 and markedly lower on Part 3. These figures are a starting point only; replace them with the school's own reference (Section 6.4) as soon as it exists.

6. Reading the profile

6.1 What the shape means

Read the four scores together with the student's papers, the interview and what the family has told you. Look first at the **shape**: which parts are strong, which are weak **relative to the student's own other parts**, and whether the shape fits the rest of the day. A difference of **3 or more** between two of the parts out of 12 is worth noting; smaller differences are noise.

Profile	What it usually means	Provisional guidance for support planning
Non-verbal and quantitative both 9 or more, verbal low (4 or less, or 3 or more below the others)	Strong reasoning; English is the gap. The verbal items use common words only, so a low score here with strong non-verbal is almost always English, not reasoning.	Plan English support (ESL, reading and vocabulary) rather than learning support. Expect the student's results to rise quickly as their English grows. Say so in the readiness comment.

Profile	What it usually means	Provisional guidance for support planning
All three of Parts 1 to 3 at 4 or less	The student found reasoning with shapes, numbers and words all hard in the time given. This could be ability, anxiety, a misunderstanding of the task, a bad day or a known need.	Do not read it as a verdict. Check that the student understood the task (the practice and examples), look at the maths and science papers and the interview, and **discuss further assessment before a decision** (Admissions Guide Section 9). If the student joins, plan close monitoring in the first term and ask the family about any earlier assessment.
Processing speed well below the others (for example 25 or fewer boxes with Parts 1 to 3 at 8 or more, or a very slow rate with few errors)	The student reasons well but works slowly on a simple paper task. Common causes: reading and writing fluency, carefulness, unfamiliarity with the task, a visual or motor difficulty, or a processing speed difficulty.	**Consider extra time** in school assessments and check **reading fluency** (the sentence reading screen's fluency rating and the reading paper's stopping point). Watch for a student who runs out of time on every paper. If the pattern repeats in the first term, suggest a specialist assessment for access arrangements in public exams.
Strong profile, weak paper results (Parts 1 to 3 at 9 or more, but maths or science bands of 1 or 2, or English well below what the verbal score suggests)	The student can reason but has not learnt, or did not show, the content. Common causes: gaps in prior learning (a different school sequence, a change of school, time out of school), low motivation, or a day that went badly.	**Look for gaps in prior learning** (the NT topics on the grading sheet, the family's account of schooling) **or motivation** (the interview). Plan catch-up in the specific topics rather than general support, and set early targets to check that the student engages.
Quantitative strong, non-verbal weak (3 or more apart)	Comfortable with numbers, less so with visual patterns. Often a well-drilled maths background; sometimes a visual processing issue.	Usually no action. If the student also struggles with diagrams, graphs and geometry on the maths paper, note it for the maths teacher.
Non-verbal strong, quantitative weak (3 or more apart)	Sees patterns in shapes but not in numbers. Often number fluency or confidence; sometimes maths anxiety.	Compare with maths Section A (fluency). Plan number fluency support in maths if the paper agrees.
Even profile, all parts middling (5 to 8 each, Part 4 around 30 to 40)	A typical entrant. Nothing in the screen suggests a particular need.	No action from the screen. Plan from the papers and the interview as usual.
Everything high, Part 4 high (10 or more in each part, 45 or more boxes)	Fast, accurate reasoning across the board.	No support need from the screen. Consider stretch (for example Further Maths or an extra subject) if the papers agree.

6.2 What the screen cannot tell you

- It **cannot diagnose** dyslexia, dyscalculia, ADHD, a processing speed disorder or any other learning difficulty. It can only say "this pattern is worth a closer look". A **specialist assessment** by an educational psychologist or a qualified specialist teacher is needed for a diagnosis and for formal access arrangements in public examinations.
- It **cannot measure intelligence** or potential, and it must not be described to students or families as doing so. Describe it as "a short screen that helps us plan support".
- It **cannot separate** a student's reasoning from their English in Part 3, their attention on the day, their familiarity with this kind of task (students who have practised similar puzzles score higher) or their test anxiety. Part 1 is the most robust to English; none of the parts is robust to a bad day.
- It **cannot be compared with published tests**. A score of 9 out of 12 here means nothing in the terms of any commercial test, and the screen has not been checked for reliability or validity.
- A **single screen cannot track change**. If a student's profile raises a question, the answer comes from watching them learn in the first term, not from giving the screen again.

6.3 Talking to the family

Give the family the plain facts if they ask: the four raw scores, what each part is, and that the screen is for planning support and does not affect the decision. Do not offer an interpretation that sounds like a diagnosis. If the profile suggests a closer look (the second or third rows of the table in 6.1), say that the school would like to understand how the student learns best and ask whether any earlier assessment exists.

6.4 Building the school's own reference

The screen becomes more useful once the school knows what its own entrants typically score.

1. Record every student's four raw scores in the admissions tracker (the Year 11 and Year 12 sheets have columns for them), including students who were not offered a place.
2. After **about 30 students** have taken the screen, work out for each part the **median** and the **lower and upper quartiles** (the 25th and 75th percentile scores). Write them in a short note kept with this guide, with the date and the number of students.
3. From then on, describe each new student's score as "above the upper quartile", "in the middle half" or "below the lower quartile" of the school's own entrants, and use these in place of the fixed numbers in Section 5 and the table in 6.1 (for example "verbal below the lower quartile with non-verbal above the median" is the English-gap profile).
4. Review the reference each year, and separately for Year 11 and Year 12 entrants once each group has about 30 students. If an item is answered correctly by almost everyone or almost no one, or the same wrong answer is chosen by most students, note it in the version register so that the item can be reviewed at the next version.

The reference describes the school's own applicants, who are not a representative population: it supports comparison within the school and nothing more.

7. Recording the result

1. **Mark the booklet** with the answer tables in Section 4. Write the score for each part at its stop banner.
2. **Copy the four raw scores onto the student's grading sheet** (`Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1` or `Y12_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) in the cognitive screen rows: **Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60**.
3. **Write the profile note** on the line provided: one or two short phrases, naming the shape and the provisional guidance from the table in 6.1, for example "Strong reasoning, English is the gap: ESL support" or "Slow coding (18) with good reasoning: check reading fluency, consider extra time" or "Even profile, no action". Add any known need or arrangement the family has told you about, and anything unusual on the day (anxiety, a misunderstanding of a task, a part not given or stopped early).
4. **Do not** enter the screen in the decision box of the final mark sheet. The final mark sheet carries the four scores and the profile note for the support plan only, marked "for planning support, never for selection".
5. **Enter the four scores in the tracker** so that the school's reference can be built (Section 6.4).
6. **File the marked booklet** with the student's other papers, or shred it under the school's policy.